

DIGNITY,
SAFETY, CONVENIENCE



4+ Crore houses built under PM Awas Yojana

25+ Crore people lifted out of poverty since 2014

12 Seal Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke



CBC 01101/13/0002/2627

CENTRE DEFENDS LPG PRICE HIKE

‘LPG still among cheapest globally, OMCs are losing ₹700 per cylinder’



FILE PHOTO/PTI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Indian households continue to pay some of the lowest cooking gas prices in the world despite a sharp rise in global liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) costs triggered by the West Asia conflict, the Centre said on Sunday, a day after state-run oil marketing companies raised domestic LPG prices by Rs 29 per cylinder. Defending the increase, the government said public sector fuel retailers are still losing around Rs 700 on every 14.2 kg domestic LPG cylinder sold, even after the latest revision, as international prices have surged and supply costs have climbed to more than Rs 1,600 per cylinder.

The latest increase has pushed the price of a 14.2 kg domestic LPG cylinder in Delhi to Rs 942 from Rs 913. It follows an earlier hike of Rs 60 on March 7, taking the total **Continued on P4**

SIR: EC empowers poll officials to flag suspected foreign nationals

State poll machinery will now share details with authorities

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission (EC) has instructed its state election machinery to refer cases of “suspected foreign nationals” to the appropriate authorities during the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, according to detailed guidelines issued for the exercise.

In instructions circulated to chief electoral officers on May 14, the poll body said Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) must forward such cases to the competent authority under the Citizenship Act, 1955. The guidelines also stated that Assistant Electoral Registration Officers would be empowered to exercise ERO powers independently for this purpose.

The directive is part of Phase III of the SIR exercise, launched by the EC on May 14 and covering 36.73 crore voters across 16 states and three Union Territories. The revision process began in a staggered manner from May 30.

The states and Union Territories included in this phase are

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Assistant EROs empowered to exercise ERO powers independently
- » Directive issued in SIR guidelines circulated on May 14
- » BLOs to probe unreturned enumeration forms during revision
- » Reasons may include absent, shifted, dead or duplicate voters
- » Phase III SIR covers 36.73 crore voters
- » SIR underway in 16 states



FILE PHOTO/ANI

and three Union Territories

nationals found in Bihar rolls

» EC earlier claimed Bangladesh, Nepal, Myanmar

» Poll body did not release numbers or proof later

Delhi, Odisha, Mizoram, Sikkim, Manipur, Uttarakhand, Andhra Pradesh, Arunachal Pradesh, Haryana, Telangana, Punjab, Karnataka, Meghalaya, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, Nagaland, Tripura, Chandigarh, and Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu.

Among them, Punjab, Jharkhand, Karnataka and Telangana are governed by opposition parties.

The EC’s instructions also laid down procedures for cases where enumeration forms are not returned. Booth Level Officers (BLOs) have been directed to

identify the likely reason behind the non-submission of forms. Based on inquiries with nearby residents, BLOs are expected to record whether the voter is absent, has shifted residence, is deceased, or is a duplicate entry in the electoral roll.

Continued on P4

INDIA bloc’s meeting today to chart strategy for Monsoon Session

Congress says INDIA ‘Janbandhan’ united, 23 parties have confirmed participation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Opposition INDIA bloc will hold a crucial strategy session in the Capital on Monday to prepare for the upcoming Monsoon Session of parliament. The session is likely to begin next month, but the dates are yet to be announced.

The meeting comes amid speculation that the government might reintroduce the two Constitution Amendment Bills, which it had failed to get passed earlier in Parliament. A united Opposition had foiled the government’s bid to pass the Delimitation and Women’s Reservation Bills, as these needed a two-thirds majority for approval.

The Congress has said 23 parties will be attending the meet. Upset with the Congress for its support to the actor-turned-politician Vijay’s TVK party in Tamil Nadu, MK Stalin’s DMK - the Congress’s former ally in South - has reiterated that it would skip the meeting.

The party had walked out of

TAKEAWAYS

- » Congress says 23 parties confirmed for INDIA janbandhan meeting
- » DMK to skip meeting amid fallout with Congress in Tamil Nadu
- » DMK exited INDIA bloc after Congress joined TVK-led alliance government
- » CPM to attend despite tensions over Rahul Gandhi’s Kerala remarks
- » AAP has publicly distanced itself from the INDIA bloc
- » Congress says alliance remains united despite diversity and differences

the INDIA bloc after the Congress called off their decades-old alliance and joined the alliance government of TVK. The CPM, which is also upset with the Congress, would still attend **Continued on P4**

Nepal backs bilateral solution to border dispute with India

Calls for partnership unconstrained by anxieties of past

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Nepal has reiterated its preference for resolving its long-standing boundary dispute with India through existing bilateral mechanisms, with Nepalese Foreign Minister Shishir Khanal saying that no issue is too difficult to settle when both sides engage with openness, reason and mutual respect.

Speaking to the media on Sunday, a day after holding extensive talks with External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar, Khanal said Kathmandu remains committed to addressing differences with New Delhi through diplomatic channels and does not support third-party mediation in the border issue.

His remarks came amid recent controversy sparked by Nepalese Prime Minister Balendra Shah’s comments suggesting that China and the United Kingdom could be involved in addressing the boundary dispute between the two neighbours.

Clarifying Nepal’s position, Khanal said the reference to the United Kingdom was limited to accessing historical documents that may be preserved in British libraries and museums.

“We want to solve our disputes through diplomatic processes. We just want to see if we can access some of the documents that might be in libraries or museums in the UK. Our position was



External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar meets Nepal Foreign Minister Shishir Khanal, in New Delhi

not that we were asking for mediation,” he said.

India had earlier rejected any role for third parties in resolving the dispute, maintaining that such matters should be addressed directly between the two countries.

Nepal and India have a long-running disagreement over the areas of Lipulekh, Limpiyadhura and Kalapani. India maintains that these **Continued on P4**

DU assistant professor murdered over property dispute; Bengal couple, minor son held

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi University assistant professor was allegedly murdered by a family from West Bengal following a prolonged dispute over ancestral property, with Delhi Police arresting a married couple and apprehending their minor son, officials said on Sunday.

Debosmita Paul, an assistant professor at Shivaji College, was found dead in her sixth-floor apartment at Satyam Apartments in east Delhi’s Vasundhara Enclave on June 3. Investigators said the killing stemmed from a long-running conflict over a property in Burdwan, West Bengal, which had been allotted to Paul through a family settlement.

According to police, the accused family had been living in the property since 2023. Paul had repeatedly asked them to vacate the premises, leading to an extended dispute. A senior police officer said the victim had recently issued a final warning to leave the property, after which the family allegedly plotted her murder and travelled nearly 1,400 kilometres to Delhi to carry out the crime.

Police said the accused were known to Paul and entered her apartment without resistance. Early findings pointed to the property **Continued on P4**

North braces for fresh heatwave as mercury likely to touch 46°C

Temperatures likely to reach 42°C-46°C in several northern states

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: A fresh spell of intense heat is set to grip large parts of north and central India this week, with temperatures expected to climb to as high as 46 degrees Celsius across several states even as the southwest monsoon continues its advance over southern and northeastern regions.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) has warned of heatwave conditions across parts of Rajasthan, Punjab, Haryana, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Himachal Pradesh over the next few days. Maximum temperatures in many areas of north-west India are likely to rise by 2 to 3 degrees Celsius until June 10 before easing thereafter.

Independent weather forecaster **Continued on P4**

TAKEAWAYS

- » IMD forecasts heatwave in Delhi, Haryana, Punjab, Rajasthan and UP.
- » Heatwave conditions likely in parts of Madhya Pradesh and Himachal Pradesh
- » Delhi-NCR may record maximum temperatures between 38°C and 44°C
- » West Rajasthan and Bundelkhand expected among worst-hit regions
- » Hot, dry northwesterly “loo” winds driving temperature surge
- » High-pressure system and clear skies adding to intense heating



PIC/ANI

- » Dry soil conditions reducing cooling from evaporation
- » IMD says northwest temperatures may rise another 2-3°C till June 10

RAJOKARI FLYOVER

Woman killed, five injured as car hits tempo; driver caught

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 47-year-old woman was killed and five others, including three children, were injured after a Toyota Innova allegedly rammed into a tempo from behind on the Rajokari flyover in southwest Delhi's Vasant Kunj area early Sunday, police said.

The accident occurred at around 4.20 am on the carriageway towards Gurugram. A PCR call regarding the incident was received shortly after the crash, and local police rushed to the spot, they said. During preliminary enquiry, police found that the Innova allegedly hit the tempo from behind, causing the three-wheeler to overturn on the flyover.

The occupants of the tempo were residents of Seelampur in northeast Delhi and were travelling to a temple in Guru-



gram when the accident took place, officials said.

The woman who died was identified as Kripa Devi (47), who succumbed to her injuries at the spot, they said.

Five other occupants of the tempo sustained injuries and were shifted to the Safdarjung Hospital through CATS

ambulances. They were identified as Vansh (8), Savitri Devi (60), Naina (34), Naksh (14) and Ishan (2). The condition of the injured was not immediately known.

Police said the tempo driver also sustained minor injuries in the accident.

According to the Delhi Fire

HIGHLIGHTS

» The occupants of the tempo were residents of Seelampur in north-east Delhi and were travelling to a temple in Gurugram when the accident took place

» The woman who died was identified as Kripa Devi (47), who succumbed to her injuries at the spot, on officer said

Service (DFS), it received information about the accident at 4.35 am and dispatched a team to the location. However, by the time firefighters reached the spot, PCR personnel had already shifted the injured to Safdarjung Hospital and AIIMS Trauma Centre.

A senior police officer said

crime and forensic teams were called to the scene to examine the circumstances surrounding the crash. The teams inspected the accident site, documented evidence and collected samples as part of the investigation.

The alleged driver of the Innova involved in the accident was found present at the spot and was apprehended by police. "During initial assessment, the driver appeared to be under the influence of alcohol or some intoxicating substance," an officer said.

The suspect underwent a medical examination, and further legal proceedings are being carried out based on the findings, police said.

A case has been registered, and investigators are examining all aspects of the incident, including the sequence of events leading to the collision.

Girl dies while playing as old brick pillar collapses

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A six-year-old girl died after an old brick pillar collapsed on her while she was playing on a makeshift swing in outernorth Delhi's Holambi Khurd area, police said on Sunday.

The incident took place in Metro Vihar in the Narela Industrial Area on Saturday, they said, adding that no foul play has surfaced during the initial inquiry and the incident appears to be accidental in nature. After receiving information regarding a girl having fallen into a drain on Saturday, "A police team immediately rushed to the spot and found the minor lying unconscious on the surface of a covered safety tank," a senior police officer said.

The child, a resident of Metro Vihar, Holambi Khurd, was shifted to Satyawadi Raja Harish Chandra Hospital, where doctors declared her brought dead, the officer said.

Her body was later sent to the mortuary of Babu Jagjivan

Ram Memorial Hospital in Jahangirpuri for preservation and further legal proceedings.

During the course of inquiry, police found that the girl had been playing on a rope swing tied to an old brick pillar. The other end of the rope had been fastened to a metal grill fixed to a nearby wall.

"Preliminary investigation revealed that the brick pillar was in a dilapidated condition. While the girl was using the swing, the weakened structure suddenly gave way and collapsed, striking her and causing fatal injuries," he further said.

Police said the pillar appeared old and unstable and may not have been capable of bearing the stress of the swing. Local residents gathered at the spot after the incident, while police inspected the area and recorded statements of family members and witnesses.

The police are examining all aspects as part of the investigation. Further inquiry is underway to ascertain the exact circumstances that led to the collapse, police added.

Man dies after plaster falls from high-rise

GREATER NOIDA: A 46-year-old man died after a piece of plaster allegedly fell from a high-rise building at Arihant Amber Society in Greater Noida on Saturday. Police said Vikas Chawla was riding his motorcycle out of the society when the plaster struck him, causing him to lose balance and fall. He suffered severe head injuries after hitting a wall and was declared dead at a hospital.

Residents protested following the incident, alleging that plaster had fallen from walls and balconies on earlier occasions as well. They claimed repeated complaints were ignored, raising concerns over construction quality and safety standards. **MPOST**

Ggm: Security officer shoots dead wife & son after domestic dispute

GURUGRAM: A 50-year-old security officer allegedly shot dead his wife and son with his licensed pistol following a domestic dispute at their residence in Gurugram's Ashok Vihar colony in the early hours of Sunday, police said.

The accused, identified as Anil, has been taken into custody and an FIR has been registered at the Palam Vihar police station, they said.

His wife Asha (45), principal of a private school, and son Prashant (25) died in the incident. According to the police, the couple frequently quarrelled and had an argument late on Saturday night. During the altercation, Prashant, who was sleeping in another



room, woke up after hearing loud voices and attempted to intervene. Anil allegedly pulled out his licensed pistol and opened fire on his wife and son, killing both on the spot, the police said. Residents said they heard multiple gunshots from the house and rushed to the spot. On finding the two lying in a pool of blood, they alerted the police.

Police and forensic teams

reached the scene, inspected the house and collected evidence. The premises were later sealed for investigation.

Officials said that when police arrived, Anil was found sitting near the bodies. The victims were taken to a civil hospital where doctors declared them dead.

Police said Anil had earlier worked as a physical education teacher and sports trainer in schools before joining a private company as a security officer.

"We are questioning the accused and reviewing his records. The bodies will be handed over to the family after the post-mortem. Further investigation is underway," a senior police officer said. **MPOST**

Blaze engulfs New Friends Colony house; 7 rescued, two dogs perish

NEW DELHI: Two pet dogs died of suffocation while seven residents, including four children, were rescued after a fire broke out at a house in New Friends Colony here around 3:45 pm on Sunday, an official said. The blaze erupted at house number C-600, trapping residents on the upper floors as thick smoke engulfed the building and blocked the central staircase, he said.

Police said two pet dogs were found unconscious from smoke inhalation.

"Emergency first aid and CPR were administered at the spot. However, one dog died of suffocation there, while the other was rushed to a nearby veterinary facility but suc-

cumbed," they said.

Cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) is a life-saving medical procedure used when a person's heartbeat or breathing stops. It is also applied to animals.

A Delhi Fire official said they rescued two dogs, but couldn't resuscitate them.

Police said after receiving a PCR call regarding the fire, local police teams and other rescue agencies, including the Delhi Fire Service (DFS), rushed to the spot in south-east Delhi. "Teams found fire originating from the first floor of the building. The flames and thick smoke had rendered the main staircase unusable, leaving several occupants and two

dogs stranded inside," a senior police officer said.

Using specialised equipment and alternative access routes, seven residents, including two women, one man and four children, were rescued from the building, police said.

Clarifying reports of a child's death, the officer stated that circulating reports about a child dying in the incident are incorrect. No human casualty has been reported, he said.

The DFS said a water bowser, a quick response vehicle and fire tenders were initially rushed to the location. Additional firefighting resources were subsequently deployed to bring the situation under control, it said. **MPOST**

22-yr-old saved after suicide bid

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 22-year-old man was rescued by Delhi Police personnel after he allegedly attempted suicide by hanging himself inside his room in Ghazipur on Sunday, an official said. The incident took place in Mulla Colony around 3.30 pm when police received information that a man had locked himself inside a room and was attempting to end his life.

"Acting swiftly on the alert, Head Constable Amit Kasana and Constable Manish rushed to the spot and found the room locked from inside," a police officer said.

The two policemen immediately reached the upper floor

of the house, broke open the door and entered the room. They found the man trying to hang himself from a ceiling fan and promptly brought him down, preventing a tragedy, he said. The man was shifted to a nearby hospital for medical examination and treatment. According to police, information about the incident was conveyed to Ghazipur police station by a member of the Aman Committee, who alerted authorities about the emergency.

Police said timely intervention saved the man's life. After treatment and counselling, he was handed over to his family, with further counselling and support being arranged.

AIIMS faces scrutiny over long duty hrs

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Concerns over the mental health and well-being of doctors working in some of the country's busiest hospitals have once again come under the spotlight after allegations of excessive duty hours, denial of weekly offs and workplace toxicity at the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Delhi reignited the debate over whether enough is being done to protect young medical professionals from burnout.

The issue gained attention following a detailed social media post by a user who claimed that dozens of junior residents left AIIMS Delhi in 2025 due to what were described as "inhumane" working conditions. According to the post, resident doctors are routinely subjected to demanding shifts lasting between 24 and 36 hours, often without adequate rest, and in some cases are allegedly denied weekly offs.

The post further alleged that certain departments do not maintain accurate records of actual duty hours and leave schedules, making it difficult to monitor compliance with residency guidelines. It also claimed that sleep deprivation, inadequate access to meals and verbal abuse by seniors and faculty members contribute significantly to stress among resident doctors.

The allegations have renewed focus on the broader issue of mental health among medical professionals, many of whom work under intense pressure while balancing patient care, academic commitments and emergency duties. Medical associations and resident doctors across the country have repeatedly raised concerns about burnout, depression and fatigue linked to excessive workloads and prolonged working hours.

Two serial pickpockets targeting tourists arrested by Delhi Police

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested two alleged serial pickpockets accused of targeting tourists in the busy Paharganj-Nabi Karim area and recovered cash, identity documents and other items linked to multiple theft and robbery cases. The accused were identified as Yug alias Yuge (21), a resident of Multani Dhandha, Paharganj, and Dev alias Laddu (22), also a resident of Multani Dhandha.

The arrests were made by a team from Nabi Karim Police Station following a detailed investigation and intelligence-based operation.

Police recovered Rs 2,700 linked to a case registered at Nabi Karim Police Station, an Aadhaar card and ATM card connected to an e-FIR lodged at Paharganj Police Station, and Rs 1,500 in cash, an Aadhaar



card and a blade allegedly used in a robbery case registered at Nabi Karim. The breakthrough came after a 29-year-old tourist from Uttar Pradesh reported on June 4 that two unidentified youths had deliberately collided with him near Bikaner Sweets in Multani Dhandha and stolen Rs 9,000 from his trouser pocket while he was on his way to breakfast.

Based on the complaint, a case was registered at Nabi Karim Police Station and an investigation was launched. A dedicated police team analysed CCTV footage from the area and identified the suspects.

Acting on specific intelligence, officers apprehended the duo on June 6 near Kuda Khatta on Qutub Road.

During interrogation, the accused allegedly confessed to targeting tourists in the Paharganj and Nabi Karim areas by deliberately bumping into them to distract them and steal their belongings. They further disclosed that when suitable targets were not available during the day, they resorted to robberies during the evening and night. Police said further questioning revealed their involvement in another pickpocketing case registered at Paharganj Police Station and a robbery case at Nabi Karim Police Station.

According to police, both accused have previous criminal records, with Yug involved in multiple cases of robbery, theft and other offences. Further investigation is underway.

PARTICIPANTS LEARN TO IDENTIFY COMMON CYBER FRAUDS

Shahdara Dist Police hold mega cyber awareness drive for senior citizens, reach over 250 residents

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Shahdara District Police organised a mega cyber awareness programme for senior citizens, equipping more than 250 elderly residents with the knowledge and practical tools needed to protect themselves from the growing threat of cyber fraud and online scams.

The initiative, aimed at enhancing digital safety and cyber resilience among vulnerable sections of society, witnessed enthusiastic participation from senior citizens across the district.

The programme was attended by senior Delhi Police officers, including Special Commissioner of



Police (Law & Order Zone-I) Devesh Chandra Srivastava, Joint Commissioner of Police (Eastern Range) Dr Ajit Kumar Singla, and Deputy Commissioner of Police (Shahdara) R.P. Meena.

Addressing the gathering, the officers stressed that awareness remains the most effective defence against cyber criminals, who increasingly exploit fear, trust, greed and limited digital literacy to target unsuspecting citizens.

Cyber experts and police

“Awareness remains most effective defence against cyber criminals, who increasingly exploit fear, trust, greed...”

officials educated participants about emerging cyber threats and the tactics commonly employed by fraudsters. The sessions covered a wide range of cyber crimes, including digital arrest scams, fraudulent calls impersonating police, bank and government officials, OTP and KYC frauds, online investment scams, call-merging frauds, Gmail and social media account hacking, impersonation scams, and UPI-related financial frauds.

A major highlight of the

programme was an interactive street play (nukkad natak), which used realistic scenarios to demonstrate how cyber criminals deceive victims through fake police calls, investment traps, social media impersonation and digital payment frauds. The performance received an overwhelming response and helped simplify complex cyber crime concepts for the audience.

Officials advised participants never to share OTPs, passwords, card details, PINs

or banking credentials and urged them to verify any request involving money or personal information.

They also cautioned citizens against clicking on suspicious links or installing applications recommended by unknown callers.

The police emphasised the importance of reporting cyber frauds immediately through the National Cyber Crime Helpline 1930 or the cyber-crime reporting portal.

Concluding the programme, officers urged citizens to remain vigilant and spread awareness about cyber safety, reiterating the message: "Think before you click, verify before you trust, and report before it is too late."

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: The Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) has initiated plans to develop 10 additional sectors in the rapidly expanding Yamuna City region to support international industrial projects, strengthen infrastructure, and provide affordable housing for economically weaker sections (EWS) and workers.

According to officials, the authority has begun creating a land bank to facilitate the expansion. The proposed sectors will accommodate major projects, including the planned Japanese Industrial Township and Singapore City, while supporting the growing development around the upcoming Noida International Airport.

YEIDA Chief Executive Officer R.K. Singh said "the



authority's immediate focus is on developing areas surrounding the airport. The state government has already approved Rs 2,800 crore for land acquisition, which is expected to accelerate development activities in the region."

At present, Yamuna City comprises 52 sectors. Under the Master Plan 2041 nearly 75,000 hectares spread across Gautam Buddha Nagar and Bulandshahr districts are being developed in phases. More than 35,000 hectares have already

witnessed significant development work, officials said.

YEIDA has also issued a Request for Proposal (RFP) for preparing a service master plan covering water supply, sewerage and drainage systems across 46 additional sectors. The initiative aims to create a robust infrastructure framework capable of meeting the needs of a rapidly growing population and industrial base.

Alongside industrial and infrastructure development, authorities are focusing on

affordable housing. Land measuring around 18,000 square metres has been identified near Biraunda village for the construction of high-rise housing for EWS families and workers. The project will feature 12-storey residential towers with 30-square-metre flats, elevators and provision for daily-use retail shops. Similar land has also been identified in Patwari village in Greater Noida West.

Greater Noida CEO Ravi Kumar NG said the authority is committed to providing quality and affordable housing for workers and low-income families. Detailed project planning is expected to begin soon after the finalisation of land parcels.

Officials said the combined focus on industrial growth, infrastructure and social housing will transform Yamuna City into a modern and inclusive urban hub in the coming years. **MPOST**

CM announces Rs 138 cr sewer proj in Karawal Nagar

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Sunday announced a Rs 138 crore sewer development project in North East Delhi's Karawal Nagar constituency, a BJP statement said. Gupta, along with Delhi BJP president and Union Minister Harsh Malhotra, announced the project in a public meeting held under Sewa Pakhwara of the party, marking 12 years of the Modi government at the Centre.

"Development works worth over Rs 300 crore have been approved in the Karawal Nagar Assembly constituency during the past year through the Chief Minister's Development Fund, MLA Fund, and the Yamuna Paar Development Board," Gupta said.

Work has commenced on a

Rs 138-crore sewer line project, which will significantly speed up sewer infrastructure development in Sonia Vihar, Milan Garden, Chauhan Patti, Sabhapur Extension, and other areas.

The chief minister stated that three Atal canteens have already been launched in the area. Additionally, three Arogya Mandirs have been approved to provide better healthcare facilities to citizens.

Malhotra said the government had launched a sewer development project in Karawal Nagar and made the Yamuna stretch from Sonia Vihar to Wazirabad "nearly clean". MPs and MLAs, including Manoj Tiwari, Kapil Mishra, Parvesh Sahib Singh and Ajay Mahawar, attended the event. **MPOST**

JUNE 14: CM GUPTA TO LEAD DRIVE

Delhi to launch mega Yamuna riverfront clean-up campaign

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major push to revive the Yamuna and mobilise public participation for environmental conservation, the Delhi government will organise a city-wide Yamuna Riverfront Cleanliness Campaign on June 14, with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta set to personally join thousands of volunteers in a large-scale clean-up effort across multiple riverfront locations.

The campaign, aimed at cleaning the Yamuna's banks and raising awareness about environmental protection, will see simultaneous cleanliness drives and public outreach programmes at major ghats along the river. Officials said nearly 500 social, religious, educational and voluntary organisations are expected to participate, along with thousands of citizens and volunteers.



Announcing the initiative, Gupta stressed the importance of collective action in restoring the river's health and ecological significance.

"The Yamuna is not merely a river but an integral part of Delhi's cultural, religious and environmental heritage," the Chief Minister said. She added that protecting the river is a shared responsibility that

extends beyond government agencies.

"With this vision, the large-scale campaign is being organised to spread awareness and encourage collective participation," she said.

The government said extensive arrangements are being made in coordination with the police, Municipal Corporation of Delhi, Health Department

TAKEAWAYS

» Announcing the initiative, Gupta stressed the importance of collective action in restoring the river's health and ecological significance

» 'The Yamuna is not merely a river but an integral part of Delhi's cultural, religious and environmental heritage,' the Chief Minister said

and other agencies. Measures related to security, traffic management, drinking water, sanitation, first aid and emergency services are being put in place to facilitate smooth conduct of the event.

The Chief Minister recalled the response to last year's 'Meri Yamuna, Mera Kartavya' campaign, during which thousands of volunteers participated and

over 12 tonnes of waste were collected and scientifically disposed of.

Officials said the upcoming drive will be conducted on a much larger scale, building on the momentum generated by previous awareness campaigns.

Emphasising the need for sustained public engagement, Gupta said, "Keeping the Yamuna clean is not a one-day campaign but a shared responsibility."

Urging citizens, youth groups and civil society organisations to join the initiative, she added, "Only through public involvement can the dream of a clean, pristine and life-giving Yamuna be realised."

The June 14 campaign is expected to be one of the largest citizen-led river cleanliness initiatives undertaken in the capital in recent years, with the government hoping it will strengthen long-term efforts to restore the Yamuna.

Delhi targets cleaner mobility with 2,800 new electric buses

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government plans to induct 2,800 air-conditioned low-floor electric buses under the Centre's PM E-DRIVE scheme as part of its push to strengthen public transport and accelerate the transition to sustainable mobility in the national capital.

According to the Transport Department, the proposed fleet will comprise 1,400 nine-metre and 1,400 twelve-metre pure electric buses.

The new buses are expected to improve connectivity across the city, enhance commuter convenience and strengthen last-mile transport services, particularly in underserved and peripheral areas.

Announcing the plan on Sunday, Delhi Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said, "Delhi is committed to building a cleaner, greener and more efficient public transport system. The planned induction of 2,800 new electric buses will significantly strengthen connectivity, improve commuter convenience and accelerate our transition towards sustainable



mobility. This initiative reflects our commitment to providing world-class public transport while reducing vehicular emissions across the city."

Officials said the decision follows the encouraging performance of nine-metre electric buses already operating in Delhi, which have proven effective in meeting local and feeder transport requirements. The government now aims to create a balanced fleet capable of serving both high-density corridors and neighbourhood routes.

The expansion forms part of the Delhi government's broader strategy to increase the share of zero-emission vehicles in public transport.

The government has set a

target of expanding the city's overall bus fleet to nearly 14,000 buses by 2028-29.

At present, Delhi operates nearly 4,300 electric buses, one of the largest such fleets in the country. The government aims to increase this number to around 7,500 by the end of the year.

The minister also said the government is pursuing the induction of 3,330 additional electric buses under PM E-DRIVE Phase-II. These include 500 seven-metre electric buses intended to strengthen feeder services and improve last-mile connectivity in residential, rural and underserved areas.

Officials said the expansion will be supported by the development of charging and power infrastructure at bus depots to facilitate large-scale electrification of the fleet.

The government expects the initiative to help reduce vehicular emissions, improve air quality and provide residents with a cleaner and more reliable public transport system while advancing national sustainability goals.

Teachers seek equal access to Science, Commerce streams for NIOS students

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Government School Teachers' Association has appealed to Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood to revise the Class 11 admission policy in government schools, alleging that students who pass Class 10 through the National Institute of Open Schooling face discriminatory restrictions.

In a representation submitted to the minister, the association claimed that NIOS students are not allowed to seek admission to the Science and Commerce streams in Delhi government schools, regardless of their academic performance. It argued that such restrictions unfairly limit the educational choices available to students from a recognised national board.

The association pointed out that NIOS functions under the Ministry of Education and its certificates are recognised by the Central Board of Secondary Education, the Association of Indian Universities and

Seeking policy changes, the association urged the DoE to permit NIOS students to apply for Science and Commerce streams on the same basis as students from other recognised boards

other regulatory bodies.

It said students who perform well in subjects such as Mathematics and Science should be considered for admission based on merit and eligibility criteria rather than the board from which they completed their studies.

The teachers' body also raised concerns over admission norms for the Humanities stream, claiming that some NIOS students are unable to secure admission because of

prescribed percentage requirements. According to the association, this particularly affects students from economically weaker backgrounds who rely on open schooling to complete their education.

Seeking policy changes, the association urged the Directorate of Education to permit NIOS students to apply for Science and Commerce streams on the same basis as students from other recognised boards. It also requested the removal of blanket restrictions, relaxation of Humanities admission conditions and issuance of a clarification recognising NIOS certificates for admission purposes.

The association further called for the formation of a committee to review the existing admission policy and address barriers faced by students from non-traditional educational backgrounds. It maintained that access to education should not be restricted for students holding qualifications from recognised boards.

AIMAN FATIMA & ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has intensified its crackdown on illegal constructions, encroachments and violations of building safety norms across the capital, with enforcement agencies carrying out action in areas such as Khanpur and Sainik Farm while the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) reported demolition or sealing of 208 properties since June 1.

Acting on directions issued by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, authorities conducted inspections and enforcement action on Sunday against structures found to be violating approved building plans and prescribed safety norms. The drive comes amid heightened concerns over building safety following recent incidents in Delhi and other parts of the country.

Violations of the ground-plus-five limit and prescribed construction norms will not be accepted under any circumstances

The Chief Minister said the government would not tolerate any illegal construction that endangers public safety. She stated that action would continue against unauthorised constructions, violations of fire safety norms and departures from approved building standards. "The government is working with the safety of citizens as its highest priority. Violations of the ground-plus-five limit and prescribed construction norms will not be accepted under any circumstances in the capital," Gupta said. She added that the government was also exploring long-term reforms, including the possibility of introducing a third-party insurance mechanism for public-use buildings, guest houses and nursing

homes to strengthen compliance with safety standards.

Malviya Nagar MLA and Delhi Jal Board Vice Chairman Satish Upadhyay said action was being taken wherever illegal construction activities or violations of prescribed building standards were detected. "Safeguarding Delhi's future remains a priority for the government, and any compromise with people's lives will no longer be tolerated at any cost," he said.

As part of the campaign, the Revenue Department carried out inspections across multiple districts. Notices and show-cause notices were issued in North, East, West, South West, South East, North West and North East districts. In Central North District, 19

sites saw sealing, demolition or issuance of show-cause notices, while one property was sealed and notices issued at 10 sites in Central District.

Meanwhile, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has intensified its city-wide campaign against unauthorised constructions and violations of building by-laws, carrying out demolition and sealing actions against 208 properties since June 1.

According to the civic body, action was taken against 94 properties through demolition and 114 properties through sealing across various zones of the Capital. On Saturday alone, MCD demolished 12 properties and sealed 79 others as part of what it described as an extensive enforcement drive.

The action, undertaken in pursuance of directions issued by Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta,

targeted properties allegedly involved in unauthorised construction, misuse of premises, and violations of safety regulations.

South Delhi witnessed a significant share of the operation, with 21 enforcement actions carried out in areas including Said-ul-Azab, Hauz Rani, Khirki Extension, Savitri Nagar, Khanpur and Gautam Nagar. These included three demolitions and 18 sealing actions. Since June 1, a total of 41 actions have been undertaken in these localities.

MCD officials said properties found operating bed-and-breakfast guest houses without requisite permissions, running commercial activities in residential premises, and illegally using basements were among those targeted during the drive. MCD issued 158 notices and demolition orders, launched surveys to identify violations, and vowed continued strict action.

Cycling promotes healthy lifestyle & reduces fuel consumption: Min

NEW DELHI: Delhi education minister Ashish Sood on Sunday announced plans to organise large-scale Yoga Day events across Janakpuri and extend support to local sports clubs, while leading a cycle rally to promote fitness and environmental awareness.

Participating in the "Pedal the Beat - Sunday on Cycle" campaign in Janakpuri, Sood urged residents, particularly the youth, to adopt cycling and other physical activities as part of their daily routine. The rally, which included residents, fit-

ness enthusiasts, women and senior citizens, began from SKV, A-Block, and concluded at CM Shri School in Janakpuri, according to a statement. Sood told participants that cycling promotes a healthy lifestyle and reduces pollution and fuel consumption.

The minister said the campaign promotes fitness and sustainable living. He urged residents to join International Day of Yoga events on June 21 and encouraged youngsters to form sports clubs with government support. MP05T

'Rekha Gupta coordinating with Hry CM for additional water in Delhi; AAP leaders lying'

NEW DELHI: The BJP has slammed AAP leaders of spreading "lies" about Chief Minister Rekha Gupta's remarks on water shortage in Delhi, saying she has coordinated with her Haryana counterpart Nayab Singh Saini to secure additional water for the city. Delhi government officials on Sunday also said that the AAP was engaging in "misinformation" over the issue of water shortage and reasons for loss of water.

Several AAP leaders, including party's Delhi unit president Saurabh Bharad-

waj, have targeted Gupta over her recent statement that evaporation and leakages were some of the reasons behind loss of water and shortage faced in summer.

Delhi a net deficient state in terms of water and depends on neighbouring Haryana and UP to meet its need. Water supply is under tremendous strain during the summer season every year as the water level in the river drops.

Delhi government officials, defending the chief minister's statement, cited a study published in 2019 that claims evap-

oration and other losses from open canal are estimated to be 30 per cent. It also estimated groundwater recharge potential of the city using rounded-off average of the past 50 years of rainfall and pan evaporation data. BJP national spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari, in a post on X, alleged that Aam Aadmi Party was "lying".

He shared a video of the Gupta in which she is citing evaporation and leakages while saying that she has contacted with Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini for more Yamuna water to meet the shortage in Delhi.

AAP leaders used a shorter version of her speech to target her, BJP said.

"AAP claiming: 'Delhi is facing a water crisis because the water supplied to residents evaporates before it reaches them,' says CM Rekha Gupta."

"REAL FACT: The truth is that, keeping Delhi's water requirements in mind, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta ji took the initiative and coordinated with Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini to secure additional water supply for the people of Delhi," Bhandari posted. P11

PROMISES ACTION ON LOCAL ISSUES

Chahal leads plantation drive and reviews civic issues in Moti Bagh

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) Vice-Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal on Sunday participated in a tree plantation drive at North West Moti Bagh as part of the #EkPed-MaaKeNaam_OnSunday campaign, an initiative inspired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi's call for environmental conservation.

The programme, held at the community centre in North West Moti Bagh, saw participation from residents, representatives of Residents' Welfare Associations (RWAs), and NDMC officials. Saplings were planted in the names of participants' mothers, symbolising gratitude while promoting environmental awareness.

Before the plantation drive, Chahal interacted with residents and RWA representatives,



Programme held at the community centre in Moti Bagh

who raised concerns regarding civic amenities in the area. Issues highlighted included tree pruning, installation and maintenance of electric poles, air-conditioning facilities at the community centre, upkeep of parks, the demand for a badminton court, and the need for additional sanitation staff.

Chahal directed the con-

cerned NDMC departments to address the issues and, where feasible, ensure their resolution within a month. Addressing the gathering, he described the campaign as more than a plantation programme, calling it a public movement aimed at strengthening environmental consciousness. He said NDMC was organising plantation drives every Sunday across its jurisdiction and that multiple departments were working together to ensure the survival and maintenance of newly planted saplings.

The Vice-Chairperson also appealed to residents to place earthen water bowls for birds during the summer months, stressing that biodiversity conservation was an essential component of environmental protection. He underscored the importance of public participation in building a cleaner and greener urban environment.

Parvesh Singh calls for citizen-centric governance, faster grievance redressal

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Water and PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh on Sunday directed Zonal Revenue Officers (ZROs) to strengthen their engagement with citizens and ensure that government schemes and services reach every eligible resident, stressing that transparency and accountability must remain at the core of governance.

The minister was addressing a review meeting with ZROs at Varunalaya, where discussions focused on improving field-level administration, public outreach and coordination among government departments.

During the meeting, Singh instructed officers to maintain regular contact with residents, understand local concerns and ensure that information regarding government welfare schemes and public services reaches every household. He said officers should not remain confined to offices but actively work among communities and serve as a link between the government and citizens.

Emphasising citizen-centric governance, the minister said, "The real measure of governance is what people experience in their daily lives. Every citizen should know what facilities and benefits the government is providing and how they can access them."

He further said, "Our officers must work among the people, understand their concerns and resolve issues with



honesty and sensitivity. Public service is a responsibility that demands transparency, dedication and accountability at every step."

According to officials, the meeting also focused on ensuring prompt grievance redressal and reducing delays in service delivery. Singh underlined that no eligible citizen should be deprived of government benefits due to lack of information or administrative bottlenecks.

The minister said public trust in government institutions is built through regular engagement and responsive administration. He urged officers to strengthen communication with residents and remain accessible to address local issues effectively.

Officials said the Delhi government is working towards creating a more transparent, accessible and responsive administrative system, with greater emphasis on field-level governance and public participation.

The review meeting was part of the government's broader effort to improve service delivery mechanisms and ensure that citizens experience the benefits of governance at the grassroots level.

‘MOST EQUIPMENT MANUFACTURED LOCALLY’

Defence production in India growing steadily: Rajnath Singh in Lucknow

OUR CORRESPONDENT

LUCKNOW: Defence minister Rajnath Singh on Sunday highlighted India's self-reliance in the defence sector and said most of the equipment are now being manufactured indigenously.

He was speaking at a 'Prabuddhan and Varishthajan Samvaad Kaaryakram' in Lucknow on Sunday, the city unit of the BJP said in a statement.

"India remains in a strong position despite global challenges and international crises. Under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the country is moving forward with confidence, and India's head will not be allowed to bow down under any circumstances," he said.

The minister said the country's global stature has risen under Modi, and the benefits of public welfare schemes are "reaching the last person in society".



Defence minister Rajnath Singh with Uttar Pradesh Deputy Chief Minister Brajesh Pathak during the 'Prabuddha Jan Samvaad' event, in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, Sunday

On the self-reliance achieved in the defence sector, he said country's defence production is steadily increasing, and most defence equipment is now being manufactured indigenously.

Singh, who represents Lucknow in the Lok Sabha, also said that the city is emerging as a key hub for defence production and research. "Several defence-related units, including the BrahMos missile project,

Highlights

- » The minister said the country's global stature has risen under Modi, and the benefits of public welfare schemes are 'reaching the last person in society'
- » Defence minister Singh further underscored the "marked improvement" in the law and order situation of the Uttar Pradesh

ect, have been promoted. The expansion of DRDO laboratories is providing opportunities for research and innovation to the youth," he said.

He recalled that after becoming an MP in 2014, traffic

congestion was a major issue in Lucknow. To address this, priority was given to the Ring Road project, the benefits of which are now being enjoyed by the city's residents, according to him.

Singh further underscored the "marked improvement" in the law and order situation of Uttar Pradesh.

"Five international airports have been constructed in the state, and key projects like the Lucknow-Kanpur Expressway are set to be launched soon," he said, according to the statement.

Referring to the start-up sector, Singh said there are currently around 2 lakh start-ups operating in the country, and unicorn companies symbolise India's "new economic strength".

At the programme, members of the Sikh community requested that a direct flight service or a Vande Bharat train connecting Lucknow to Amritsar be introduced, according to the statement.

Unlocking Northeast: EU eyes long-term economic partnership

'Team Europe' delegation to visit Assam on June 8-9

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The European Union is eyeing a long-term trade and investment partnership with India's Northeastern region to unlock its economic potential, focusing heavily on green energy, semiconductors, pharmaceuticals, tea, and agri-food processing.

A high-level 'Team Europe' delegation will arrive in Guwahati on Monday for a two-day visit, aiming to foster deeper economic collaboration with the eight Northeastern states: Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim, and Tripura.

This initiative aligns with the priorities established under the comprehensive strategic agenda agreed upon during the EU-India summit in January.

The delegation's visit signals a new chapter in EU-India collaboration, with a shared vision to unlock the North-East's economic potential through

This initiative aligns with the priorities established under the comprehensive strategic agenda agreed upon during the EU-India summit in January

innovation, sustainability, and inclusive growth, the EU's New Delhi mission said.

The EU delegation will comprise envoys and senior representatives from EU member states, including EU Ambassador Herve Delphin, alongside European business representatives.

"North-East India and Assam at its core, has enormous potential - its resources, its skilled workforce - and is already one of the fastest growing regions of India by GDP," Delphin said.

The Team Europe ambas-

sadors will engage in a bilateral meeting with Assam's Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, while a business delegation led by the Federation of European Businesses in India (FEBI) will also hold discussions with state officials to identify trade and investment opportunities, the EU said.

The delegation will also participate in the 'Blue Valleys: Building ecosystems and value chains between India and Europe' workshop on Tuesday organised by the Assam government, which will bring together European and Indian businesses to explore partnerships in sustainable value chains, industries and innovation.

"Through initiatives like Blue Valleys, we're not just discussing cooperation, we're building real, long-term business to business partnerships that will drive growth for both the EU and India," Delphin said.

From Page 1

SIR: EC empowers

More than 3.94 lakh BLOs have been deployed to conduct door-to-door verification of electors during the exercise. They will be assisted by around 3.42 lakh Booth Level Agents (BLAs) appointed by political parties.

The issue of identifying foreign nationals in voter lists has previously generated political controversy. While preparing for the SIR exercise in Bihar last year, EC officials had claimed that grassroots-level functionaries had detected several nationals from Bangladesh, Nepal and Myanmar in electoral rolls. However, the Commission did not subsequently release figures or documentary evidence regarding such cases.

Opposition parties had questioned those claims, alleging that the revision exercise was being used to target voters who were not aligned with the BJP and its allies.

The SIR exercise has already been completed in Bihar, West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Puducherry, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Chhattisgarh, Goa, Andaman and Nicobar Islands, and Lakshadweep. A separate special revision was conducted in Assam.

According to EC data, the combined electoral rolls of nine states and three Union Territories covered under Phase II of the SIR were reduced by 10.2 per cent following the revision. More than 60 lakh deceased voters were removed from the rolls during the process.

When the second phase was announced on October 27 last year, the voter base across the 12 states and Union Territories stood at over 50.99 crore. Following the revision, the number fell to 45.81 crore, a reduction of more than 5.18 crore electors.

The poll panel said schedules for similar exercises in Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, and Ladakh will be announced later, taking into account weather conditions in snow-bound regions.

For states where the SIR exercise has already been completed, such as Bihar and West Bengal, the Election Commission has not issued any clarification on whether the latest instructions regarding suspected foreign nationals will apply retrospectively to cases identified during those revisions, or whether any such cases have been referred to the competent authorities under the Citizenship Act, 1955.

The revision process has also faced legal challenges and schedule adjustments. During the Bihar exercise, political parties approached the Supreme Court against similar revisions in Tamil Nadu and West Bengal. Trinamool Congress president and then West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee had also personally appealed before a bench headed by the Chief Justice of India against the electoral roll revision exercise in her state.

Monsoon Session

the meeting. The AAP has publicly distanced itself from the INDIA bloc. CPM General Secretary MA Baby had written to Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge two days ago regarding Rahul Gandhi's comments alleging a collusion between Kerala's former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan and

the BJP.

The Congress said that 23 political parties have confirmed their participation in the "INDIA janbandhan" meeting at the Constitution Club here. The party asserted that the opposition bloc continues to stand united through its diversity.

Congress leader Jairam Ramesh said there are some parties that have expressed their inability to attend this particular meeting for their own reasons.

In a post on X, he said, "23 political parties have confirmed participation in the INDIA Janbandhan meeting at Constitution Club, New Delhi, on Monday, June 8, 2026, at 12 noon."

Tagging Ramesh's post, TMC MP Derek O'Brien said, "Meeting with a common purpose and clear intent. INDIA united. Many parties look forward to meeting in the spirit of camaraderie."

"There are some parties who have expressed their inability to attend this particular meeting for their own reasons, even though they have conveyed their strong opposition to the Modi government's policies and actions that are snatching away the right to vote for millions of Indians, assaulting the Constitution daily, attacking Opposition leaders through investigative agencies, seriously damaging the livelihoods of crores of Indians, breaking household budgets through relentless price rise, betraying the hopes and aspirations of lakhs of youth, dampening investment climate, and compromising the national interest by its foreign policy," said the Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh.

Like India, the "INDIA Janbandhan" continues to stand united through its diversity, he asserted. The INDIA bloc is set to deliberate on the future course of action with an eye on the 2029 general elections.

It would look to devise a joint strategy to corner the Modi government on national issues. The meeting also comes in the backdrop of the recent assembly elections in which TMC and DMK were ousted from power in West Bengal and Tamil Nadu.

The gathering is being seen as an effort to deepen coordination among opposition parties, particularly after the recent round of assembly elections and amid evolving political equations in several states.

TMC supremo and former West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee, party general secretary Abhishek Banerjee, Shiv Sena (UBT) chief Uddhav Thackeray, Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav, Rahul Gandhi and Kharge are among those who will be attending the meeting.

Akhilesh Yadav's Samajwadi Party, National Conference (NC), Nationalist Congress Party - Sharad Pawar (NCP-SP), and Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) have also confirmed their attendance.

LPG still among

increase since the onset of disruptions in West Asia to Rs 89 per cylinder.

Despite the rise, the government said domestic LPG remains significantly subsidised and continues to be sold below its market-linked cost. Beneficiaries of the Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY) will continue to receive a subsidy of Rs 300 per cylinder through direct benefit transfer, bringing their effective cost to Rs 642 per refill.

In a statement, the petroleum ministry said, "A PMUY beneficiary will additionally receive the direct benefit transfer of Rs 300 a cylinder on the first four refills each year and so pays an effective Rs 642 on those refills; this

support is unchanged."

The reference to four subsidised refills has raised questions because the Union Cabinet had approved a subsidy of Rs 300 per cylinder for up to nine refills annually during the 2025-26 financial year. No formal clarification has yet been issued on whether the number of subsidised refills has been revised.

The government attributed the price increase to a steep rise in global LPG prices following disruptions in the Gulf region. India's LPG import costs are linked to the Saudi Contract Price (CP), the international benchmark set by Saudi Aramco. According to the government, the benchmark climbed from about USD 543 per tonne in February to USD 790 per tonne in June.

The ministry said the increase was triggered after the closure of the Strait of Hormuz in late February, which tightened supplies from the Middle East. The April contract price, the first after the disruption, jumped to USD 775 per tonne before rising further in subsequent months. Overall, the blended LPG benchmark has increased by about 46 per cent since February. India imports around 60 per cent of its LPG requirements, making domestic prices vulnerable to movements in international markets. The government noted that while commercial LPG prices are revised automatically every month to reflect global rates, domestic cooking gas prices are moderated to shield households from sharp fluctuations.

Officials said the gap between the cost of supplying LPG and the retail price has widened considerably. Under-recoveries on domestic LPG sales are estimated to have reached nearly Rs 60,000 crore in the last financial year, up from Rs 41,338 crore a year earlier. To partly offset these losses, the Union Cabinet has approved Rs 1,755 in compensation for state-run oil marketing companies.

The ministry maintained that Indian consumers continue to enjoy lower LPG prices than households in several neighbouring countries and advanced economies. According to government figures, the equivalent cost of a 14.2 kg LPG refill is about Rs 1,046 in Pakistan and Rs 1,225 in Bangladesh. Prices are substantially higher in developed nations, with equivalent refills costing around Rs 1,755 in the United States, Rs 1,765 in Australia and Rs 2,411 in Canada.

The government also highlighted measures taken to prevent supply shortages during the crisis. Around 54 per cent of India's LPG imports move through the Strait of Hormuz, a key global shipping route affected by the conflict. To maintain supplies, domestic LPG production was increased by more than 60 per cent, from about 32,000 tonnes per day to nearly 52,000 tonnes per day. Imports were diversified to countries including the United States, Canada and Algeria.

Authorities also encouraged consumers to shift to piped natural gas where available and intensified checks against the diversion of subsidised cylinders for commercial use through wider OTP-based delivery verification.

"The prices of petroleum products in India are linked to the corresponding prices in the international market. The government, however, continues to modulate the effective price to the consumer for domestic LPG," the ministry said.

It added that while global energy costs have risen sharply, the government has absorbed a substantial portion of the burden rather than passing it entirely to consumers, ensuring uninterrupted availability of cooking fuel across the country during a period of geopolitical uncertainty and supply chain disruptions.

DU assistant

dispute as the primary motive behind the killing.

Paul had been living alone in the Delhi flat after separating from her husband in 2022. During the investigation, police also questioned her husband, who currently lives in Bengaluru.

Investigators examined CCTV footage from the housing complex and found that the accused arrived at the apartment building with their minor son. The footage allegedly showed them moving through the premises while concealing their identities and using both staircases and lifts.

Police said the family had brought the murder weapon with them and killed Paul inside her residence. They allegedly attempted to avoid detection by changing clothes after the crime and keeping their faces covered as they moved around the complex.

After the murder, the accused allegedly fled using a taxi and an autorickshaw. Police said they travelled to Anand Vihar before reaching New Delhi Railway Station, where they boarded the Poorva Express at around 5.40 pm on June 3. They arrived in Burdwan the following day. The investigation gathered pace after police detained a cab driver who had transported the suspects and analysed red records to identify them. Officers reviewed CCTV footage and records of nearly 200 visitors who entered the housing complex on the day of the murder and narrowed the list to 13 suspects for detailed scrutiny. Further investigation revealed that the accused had stayed at a guest house in Delhi's Dallupura area on June 3 before carrying out the crime. Police recovered details of two Aadhaar cards used at the guest house. The documents belonged to Satish, a resident of Nawada in Bihar, and Soma Chaudhary of Burdwan. Investigators later found that the identities were unrelated to the suspects and had allegedly been used to conceal their movements.

Mobile numbers linked to the identities were placed under electronic surveillance, helping investigators trace the suspects. Seven Delhi Police teams conducted raids across four states and questioned hundreds of people before tracking the accused to Burdwan.

A police team flew to West Bengal on June 6 and followed the suspects' movements using CCTV footage from Burdwan railway station. On June 7, officers apprehended Ramprasad Das, 42, who runs a sanitary shop in Burdwan, and his wife Banashree Das, 36, a homemaker. Their minor son was apprehended under provisions of the Juvenile Justice Act.

Police said they recovered the victim's mobile phone, a razor allegedly used to cut her wrists, a backpack, clothes, a cap believed to have been used during the crime, and train tickets and other travel documents.

The accused are being produced before the concerned court for transit remand and will be brought to Delhi for further investigation. Police said the probe is continuing.

North braces

Navdeep Dahiya said daytime temperatures across Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan, Delhi-NCR and Uttar Pradesh are expected to rise sharply from Monday, with maximum temperatures ranging between 42 degrees Celsius and 46 degrees Celsius. The peak of

the heat spell is likely around June 10 and 11.

According to the IMD, heatwave conditions are very likely in isolated pockets of Haryana, Chandigarh and Delhi between June 8 and June 11, Punjab between June 8 and June 11, west Rajasthan between June 8 and June 11, east Uttar Pradesh between June 9 and June 10, west Uttar Pradesh between June 9 and June 11, east and west Madhya Pradesh between June 10 and June 11, and Himachal Pradesh between June 9 and June 10. Coastal Andhra Pradesh and Yanam are also likely to witness heatwave conditions on June 8.

Delhi and the National Capital Region are expected to record maximum temperatures between 38 degrees Celsius and 44 degrees Celsius during the coming week. Heatwave-like conditions are also likely across parts of Gujarat and Maharashtra, although some locations may experience cloudy skies and light rainfall.

Weather experts attribute the surge in temperatures to persistent hot and dry northwesterly winds sweeping across the region. These winds travel over the Thar Desert and adjoining arid areas of Rajasthan and Pakistan, picking up heat before moving into northern India. Commonly known as "loo" winds, they reduce moisture levels and replace cooler local air with hotter air masses.

Meteorologists say another factor contributing to the rising temperatures is a high-pressure system over the region. Such systems force air to descend, warming it further as it compresses. The sinking air also suppresses cloud formation, allowing intense solar radiation to heat the ground throughout the day. Dry soil conditions in many areas have added to the problem, as limited moisture means more of the sun's energy is used to heat the air rather than evaporate water.

The IMD defines a heatwave in the plains when the maximum temperature reaches at least 40 degrees Celsius and remains 4.5 degrees Celsius or more above normal, or when the temperature touches 45 degrees Celsius irrespective of normal values. Forecast temperatures of up to 46 degrees Celsius are expected to meet these criteria in several areas, particularly in west Rajasthan and parts of Uttar Pradesh's Bundelkhand region.

The latest observations already indicate rising heat levels. On June 6, maximum temperatures ranged between 38 degrees Celsius and 42 degrees Celsius across many parts of central and eastern India, north peninsular India and Rajasthan. Sriganganagar in Rajasthan recorded the country's highest maximum temperature at 44.3 degrees Celsius. Night temperatures also remained above normal across several states, including Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu and Odisha.

While northern India braces for extreme heat, the monsoon is simultaneously advancing across other parts of the country. The IMD said the southwest monsoon has moved further into the west-central and northwestern Bay of Bengal and covered the entire north-eastern region, including Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram. Heavy to very heavy rainfall is forecast across Kerala, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and northeastern states during the next seven days, with isolated extremely heavy rainfall likely over Karnataka between June 8 and June 10. Relief from the heat in northwest India may arrive around June 13, when a western disturbance is expected to bring cloud cover, isolated rainfall and a change in wind patterns. Until then, large parts of north and central India are likely to remain under the grip of intense summer conditions even as monsoon rains gather strength elsewhere in the country.

Nepal backs bilateral solution to border dispute with India

Continued from Page 1

Territories are part of Uttarakhand, while Nepal claims them as its own.

Referring to the issue, Khanal said shared borders should function as links between people rather than obstacles. "True interdependence" means that borders should act as "highly efficient bridges, not frustrating barriers," he said.

The foreign minister also addressed Nepal's objections to the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra route through Lipulekh. He said Kathmandu's concerns stem from understandings reached between India and China regarding the route without Nepal's involvement.

"Our concerns are with the renewal of the agreement between India and China over the Kalapani and Lipulekh area, where we have said for a very long time that the land belongs to us, and without Nepal's consent, the two countries by themselves cannot make those agreements," he said.

Khanal added that Nepal had formally communicated its position to both countries through diplomatic channels and notes.

At the same time, he underlined that Nepal seeks to address the matter with India through established bilateral mechanisms.

"Rather than engaging in hyper-nationalistic grandstanding, we are pursuing calm, data-driven and evidence-based discussions to resolve challenges in good faith," he said.

Khanal was in New Delhi on a three-day visit beginning Friday. During his discussions with Jaisankar, the two sides explored ways to deepen cooperation in areas such as trade, connectivity, energy and critical technologies.

The minister described 2026 as a particularly favourable period for advancing bilateral ties.

"No problem is too large, and no boundary too complex, when we sit down with an open heart, a rational mind and mutual respect," he said.

Khanal also spoke positively about India's economic and technological progress, saying Nepal wants to engage more closely with its southern neighbour's growth story.

"When we look across the border, we see a rising India, an India that has fundamentally and beautifully redefined itself on the global stage as a dynamic, fast-growing tech and economic powerhouse," he said.

"We want to engage with this India of intense aspiration, cutting-edge technology, and relentless execution. In turn, we bring the energy of an aspiring Nepal."

He said the current Nepal government is keen to strengthen ties with India and focus on delivering practical outcomes for people.

"Our primary responsibility is to close the gap between bold promises made on paper and the physical reality delivered on the ground, transitioning away from abstract political statements to deliver measurable, life-changing results," he said.

Calling for a forward-looking partnership, Khanal said the relationship should be guided by future opportunities rather than past anxieties.

He also reflected on the deep cultural and historical links between the two countries.

"Every time on the journey from Kathmandu to New Delhi, looking down at the majestic Himalayas yielding to the vast, fertile plains of the Gangetic basin, I am reminded of a profound truth," he said.

"We are not merely neighbours joined by political lines drawn on a map; we are the children of the same rivers, the same mountains, and the same ancient wisdom."

On the report of the Eminent Persons Group (EPG), formed in January 2016 to review bilateral agreements including the 1950 India-Nepal Friendship Treaty, Khanal said the document could only be submitted to the prime ministers of the two countries.

"The report can only be submitted to the two prime ministers. I have no authority to make that public, accept or do anything," he said.

Asked about youth-led protests that brought political changes in Nepal in September 2025 and a protest in New Delhi on Saturday, Khanal declined to comment on developments in India. On US tariffs affecting Nepalese goods, he said Kathmandu remained engaged with Washington, adding, "We are in constant dialogue with the Americans."



EDITORIAL
LOYALTY TO
POWER?

The Allahabad High Court's recent observations on policing in Uttar Pradesh should alarm anyone who values constitutional democracy. Courts are generally cautious institutions, and judges rarely employ language that directly challenges the foundations of governance. Yet Justice Vinod Diwakar's remarks leave little room for ambiguity. When a constitutional court observes that a section of the police force displays greater loyalty to ruling dispensations than to the Constitution itself, it is not merely commenting on administrative inefficiency; it is questioning the health of the rule of law. Such observations strike at the very heart of democratic governance, because the police are not meant to serve governments, parties, leaders or ideologies. Their allegiance is owed exclusively to the Constitution and the laws enacted under it. Once that principle begins to erode, the distinction between a constitutional republic and a patronage-driven state starts to blur.

The court's diagnosis of Uttar Pradesh's administrative culture is particularly troubling because it describes a phenomenon that many citizens have long suspected but rarely hear articulated in judicial language. The transfer-posting ecosystem has become one of the most corrosive features of governance in several states. Officers perceived as politically compliant are rewarded with influential assignments, while those who display independence often find themselves relegated to inconsequential posts. Such a system inevitably produces incentives that undermine professionalism. When career advancement depends less on competence and more on political proximity, the bureaucracy ceases to function as a neutral instrument of the state. It becomes a mechanism for serving transient political interests. The consequences are visible in arbitrary policing, selective law enforcement and a growing perception that legal processes can be manipulated to favour some while targeting others.

What makes the High Court's observations especially significant is that they connect individual misconduct to a broader institutional culture. The judgment points to encounter killings, misuse of preventive detention laws, arbitrary arrests and selective application of criminal statutes as symptoms of a deeper malaise. These concerns are not unique to Uttar Pradesh. Across India, there has been a worrying tendency to celebrate extra-judicial methods in the name of efficiency and swift justice. Popular approval, however, cannot legitimise constitutional shortcuts. Democracies are deliberately designed to be constrained by procedure because procedures protect citizens from the arbitrary exercise of power. Every unlawful arrest, every politically motivated investigation and every instance of selective prosecution weakens public trust in institutions. When citizens begin to believe that justice depends on political influence rather than legal merit, faith in the state itself begins to crumble.

Equally disturbing is the court's criticism of the higher administrative apparatus, including the functioning of the Home Department. The suggestion that senior officials may act as conduits for personal or extraneous interests rather than impartial custodians of governance raises serious questions about accountability. The reference to the Bikru case is particularly revealing. Eight police personnel, including a deputy superintendent of police, lost their lives in one of the most shocking failures of policing in recent memory. Yet the court noted the disproportionately lenient consequences faced by those responsible for supervisory lapses. Institutional accountability cannot survive where serious failures are met with symbolic reprimands. Such impunity sends a dangerous message: that responsibility can be diluted, consequences negotiated and lessons ignored. Over time, this culture becomes self-perpetuating, shielding incompetence and encouraging further misuse of authority.

The larger lesson extends far beyond Uttar Pradesh. India's democratic future depends not merely on free elections but on the strength and neutrality of its institutions between elections. Political parties will come and go, governments will rise and fall, but institutions must remain anchored to constitutional principles. A police officer's oath is not to a chief minister, a minister or a political party; it is to the Constitution of India. The Allahabad High Court has issued a warning that should resonate across the country. Constitutional governance cannot survive if loyalty to power supersedes loyalty to law. Reforming policing, insulating transfers and promotions from political influence, strengthening accountability mechanisms and rewarding professional independence are no longer administrative preferences—they are democratic necessities. The real test of governance lies not in how effectively power is exercised, but in how faithfully it remains bound by constitutional limits.

TALKING
SHOP



RAJEEV NARAYAN

THE WRITER
IS A VETERAN
JOURNALIST AND
COMMUNICATIONS
SPECIALIST

The biggest threat to India is not that AI will end up killing crores of jobs. It is that AI will create obscene wealth elsewhere in the world, while India remains merely a supplier of cheap labour for basic-level software coding work

DIPLOMATIC
DOUBTS



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS
A RETIRED IPS
OFFICER, ADVISER
NATSTRAT, AND A
FORMER NATIONAL
SECURITY ADVISOR
IN MAURITIUS

The real issue is not whether Pakistan claims neutrality, but whether its actions match its rhetoric

India Losing the AI Race?

As Artificial Intelligence reconfigures wealth and power distribution, India risks quietly getting sidelined in this century's most defining technological faceoff

"The best way to predict the future is to invent it."

— Alan Kay

There are moments in history when entire nations miss a turn, a once-in-a-century opportunity. The Industrial Revolution created Britain. The age of mass manufacturing elevated the United States to superpower status. The electronics revolution transformed Japan. The Internet era produced Silicon Valley. Fast forward to today and it is Artificial Intelligence (AI) that is creating the next great redistribution of wealth, influence and economic power. As trillions of dollars flow into this new frontier, a disturbing question confronts India: Has the country missed the most consequential technological opportunity of the 21st century? The warning signs are impossible to ignore.

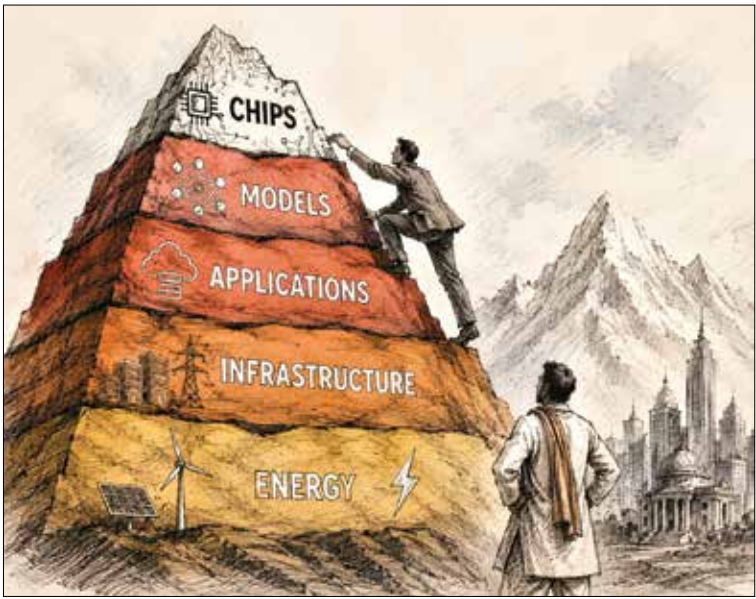
Look at Taiwan. This country which is smaller than 19 of India's states in geographical size and has a population of only 2.3 crore people recently overtook India in total stock market capitalization. That feat was not due to consumption or demographic advantage; it was built on technology. It was built on semiconductors, AI infrastructure and intellectual property. At the heart of the success stands TSMC, a company valued at US \$2 trillion, now one of the most important enterprises in the global AI ecosystem.

Discomfiting Contrast
The weigh-off should make India fidget. For years, policymakers and industry leaders have spoken about India's emergence as a 'technology powerhouse'. Yet, the technology revolution that will define the future is making India conspicuous by its absolute absence from the list of contenders.

Further, no Indian firm has built any real AI model, let alone a dominant one. There is no Indian equivalent of ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, DeepSeek or Perplexity. No Indian company sits at the height of AI stardom. No Indian company controls semiconductor supply chains that power AI ambitions worldwide. And when tech firms are adding billions of dollars in market value through AI, India remains a consumer, not a creator.

The monkey in this story is the services trap India has dug for itself. For decades, India spoke of the success of its IT industry. Sure, India's software companies generated employment, earned foreign exchange, built global reputations and transformed cities. They showed that Indian talent could compete with the best in the world. But success can sometimes become a trap.

India's business model was based on selling faux-skilled labour, rather than creating intellectual property (IP). Indian firms mastered the art of providing services to global corporations. They became indispensable



India must rise from being an AI consumer to a meaningful creator before the world's next wealth revolution leaves it behind

partners. But what they rarely became was owners of the products, patents and platforms that generated disproportionate value. Artificial Intelligence is here now and it is exposing this limitation.

In the past, global giants needed armies of programmers. But with AI, sophisticated models can write code, test software and automate functions that once justified large workforces. Ironically, the very activities that fuelled Indian IT are those most susceptible to automation today. While Silicon Valley, Beijing and Taipei invested in creating AI products and infrastructure, India happily remained focused on services.

The result is visible in the scoreboard of global market value. Companies creating AI are capturing extraordinary wealth. Companies supplying them with labour are not.

Exporting Minds
A second challenge is one that India knows all too well. Brain drain. India produces the most number of engineers and scientists worldwide, with many of these being raw AI talent. And this talent creates value elsewhere, for others. Indian researchers are building advanced models in American laboratories. Indian engineers occupy top positions in global tech firms. Indian academics contribute to frontier research. Their achievements deserve applause. But there is a difference between producing talent and creating wealth.

When IP is created abroad, the profits, strategic advantages and technological ecosystems remain abroad. Salaries may flow back through remittances, but ownership does not. Nations become rich not by

educating talent but by ensuring that talent builds institutions, products and innovations within their own economies. China understood this maxim decades ago. Taiwan figured this out even earlier. South Korea built national champions around it.

India has somehow been unable to force open the high-stakes AI lock.

Infrastructure Deficit

There's a third reason too for India's sloth-speed, one barely visible but highly decisive. It is that AI is not merely software. It is infrastructure too. Advanced AI models need massive computing power, specialised chips, sophisticated data centres and enormous quantities of electricity. The AI race is a contest of capital expenditure. Global tech firms are spending billions on data centres and acquiring computing resources. US firms alone invested US \$109 billion in AI-related ventures and startups in 2024, while global private investment in AI crossed US \$250 billion.

India traipsed into this race with significant disadvantages. It lacks a meaningful semiconductor ecosystem. Advanced GPUs remain expensive and scarce. Data centre capacity, though growing, trails competitors. Power availability remains a challenge. To top it all, Indian AI startups depend on computing infrastructure on rent from Amazon, Google and others.

This dependency matters. In the industrial age, nations that lacked steel mills could not compete. In the digital age, nations that lack AI infrastructure face a similar limp. One cannot run to the AI future by using crutches in its foundations.

The Late Arrival

The final hurdle is an unpalatable one, that India is too late to the AI circus. Tech revolutions reward early movers disproportionately. Once the ecosystem matures, advantages compound. Capital attracts capital. Talent attracts talent. Innovation attracts further innovation. Companies leading AI today enjoy data advantages, computing advantages, talent advantages and financial advantages. Their valuations allow them to invest aggressively, widening the gap further.

This does not mean India has no future in AI. It does, but not the future many imagine. The opportunity to create the next OpenAI or Nvidia has narrowed. The opportunity to dominate advanced semiconductor manufacturing is harder still. Catching leaders who already possess accumulated advantages will require resources and coordination on a scale India has rarely demonstrated.

Yet, this reality does not necessitate surrender. There are enough stories of countries succeeding not by leading the first phase of a revolution, but by mastering the second.

Beyond Rhetoric

All said, the challenge is not a shortage of talent. Nor is it a shortage of ambition. It is a shortage of clarity. For long, discussions around AI have been dominated by conferences, declarations and grand visions. Those have value, but technological leadership is not achieved through speeches. It is achieved through capital formation, research ecosystems, infrastructure creation and relentless product innovation.

The world is no longer debating whether AI will transform lives. That question has already been answered. The real question is who will own the transformation.

Given current trends, India risks becoming to the AI age what many nations were during the industrial revolutions – suppliers of labour to richer economies, with the latter owning the patents and generating extraordinary wealth. That would be a tragedy because India possesses every ingredient required for success – human capital, entrepreneurial energy, a large domestic market and a vibrant technology culture.

What India lacks is urgency. The threat facing India is not that AI will kill crores of jobs. The danger is that AI will create obscene wealth elsewhere while India twiddles its thumbs in frustration, watching in financial dismay. After all, the most important tech revolution of the 2000s is underway. Nations are choosing their place in it. India has to somehow secure a meaningful role.

The writer can be reached on narayanrajeev2006@gmail.com. Views expressed are personal

Mediator or Manipulator?

With Pakistan allegedly sheltering Iranian military aircraft, Islamabad's claim of neutrality in the Iran-US crisis faces growing scrutiny

Pakistan's attempts to project itself as a "serious" mediator in bringing about a truce to end the ongoing Iran-US-Israel military conflict stand exposed due to its diabolical role in the so-called mediation. Some time back, in these very columns, this columnist had raised doubts about Pakistan's intentions in brokering talks towards a peaceful resolution. Pakistan, once again, surfaced in the news for all the wrong reasons, chiefly due to a report emanating from US broadcaster Columbia Broadcasting System (CBS) News asserting that Iranian military aircraft were parked at the strategically important Nur Khan Airbase in Pakistan to shield them from potential American strikes. However, Pakistan's Foreign Office, on May 12, termed the narrative misleading and sensationalised. Such an argument seems far from the truth.

The CBS report further claimed that multiple Iranian aircraft, including an Iranian Air Force RC-130 reconnaissance aircraft, were moved to Nur Khan Airbase near Rawalpindi shortly after President Trump announced a ceasefire in early April this year. The report further alleged that the move was intended to protect Iranian aviation assets from possible US airstrikes during heightened tensions in the Middle East. Rejecting those assertions, Pakistan's Foreign Office also maintained that the aircraft currently parked in Pakistan "bear no linkages whatsoever to any military contingency or preservation arrangement", adding: "Assertions suggesting otherwise are speculative, misleading, and entirely detached from the factual context." Again, this argument does not seem to hold any water, and the defence remains feeble.

Pakistan, on its part, also stressed, rather faintly and unconvincingly, that it has acted as an "impartial, constructive and responsible facilitator" in efforts aimed at reducing tensions between Iran and the US. This 'defence', however, is once again far from cogent. Pakistan's Foreign Office further disclosed that despite the pause in formal negotiations,



Diplomatic efforts to stabilise the ceasefire appeared increasingly fragile, further exposing Pakistan's dubious designs

senior-level diplomatic contacts had continued and that the recent visits of the Iranian Foreign Minister to Islamabad were facilitated through existing logistical arrangements tied to the talks process. Even Iran's doubts appear to be evident regarding Pakistan's assertions on the subject under reference, as they conspicuously lack conviction. Though bereft of any logic, Pakistan's defence, according to CBS report observers, appears aimed at countering allegations that undermine both the diplomatic efforts and Pakistan's "constructive" role. Yet its attempt to project itself as a mediator capable of bringing an end to the war fails to present any realistic response.

Meanwhile, Pakistan's detractors allege that, amid Islamabad's role as a "peace broker" in the West Asia war, Pakistan had allowed its Nur Khan Airbase to shelter Iranian military intelligence aircraft. The arrangement, described by several US officials who spoke on the condition of anonymity,

suggested that Iran was seeking to preserve portions of its military aviation fleet from possible American strikes as the region edged closer to a wider war.

Crucially, according to some media reports, Iran also moved civilian aircraft into neighbouring Afghanistan as part of a broader effort to disperse aviation assets across the region, American officials said. It was, however, not yet clear whether military aircraft were also flown into Afghan territory. A senior Pakistani official denied that Iranian aircraft had been stationed at Nur Khan, calling the allegation implausible given the base's location near densely populated urban areas. This makes the arguments and counterarguments even murkier.

Importantly, in Afghanistan, an aviation official said that a civilian aircraft operated by Iran's Mahan Air landed in Kabul shortly before the conflict intensified and remained there even after Iranian airspace was closed. The official further revealed that the Taliban

authorities later relocated the aircraft to Herat, near the Iranian border, amid fears that Pakistani airstrikes targeting militant groups could endanger Kabul airport. These disclosures come as Pakistan's strategic alignment with China has deepened sharply over the past decade. Here, it is relevant to note that Chinese officials have publicly praised Islamabad's role in facilitating indirect communication between Iran and the US during the West Asia crisis.

At the same time, diplomatic efforts to stabilise the ceasefire appeared increasingly fragile, further exposing Pakistan's dubious designs. Iranian state media reported over the weekend that Tehran had already proposed terms to Pakistan for ending the conflict, including American war reparations, recognition of Iranian sovereignty over the Strait of Hormuz, and the lifting of US sanctions.

The CBS-initiated report, being highly critical, naturally triggered concern in Washington, with US lawmakers raising doubts about Islamabad's neutrality in the mediation efforts. In a post on X, senior Republican senator and Trump's close ally, Lindsey Graham, called for a reassessment of Pakistan's self-perceived diplomatic role in the crisis. This social media post appears logical, and Pakistan needs to be further exposed for its double role in siding with both the US and Iran, possibly to keep both in good humour. If this reporting is accurate, it would require a complete reevaluation of the role Pakistan is playing as a mediator between Iran, the US, and other parties. Given some of the prior statements made by Pakistani defence officials regarding Israel, the US will certainly be uneasy about Pakistan's role as a mediator. In this light, it is probably high time that President Trump recalibrates his opinion of his "favourite" Field Marshal, as well as Pakistan's political leadership, before reposing further trust and confidence in Islamabad.

Views expressed are personal

PAKISTAN INTERIOR MINISTER VISITS TEHRAN FOR THIRD TIME IN WEEKS

Pak’s Naqvi meets Iran FM; discusses status of peace talks

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan’s Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi on Sunday held a meeting with Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi in Tehran, during which he delivered a written message from Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, the Iranian government said in a statement.

The message was addressed to Iran’s Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei.

“Pakistan’s Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi met with FM @ araghchi in Tehran today, delivering a written message from PM Shehbaz Sharif addressed to the Supreme Leader of the Islamic Revolution, Ayatollah Khamenei,” the Iran government said in a post on X.

Photographs released by the Iranian authorities showed Naqvi handing over an envelope to Araghchi.

Iranian authorities did not disclose the contents of the message, and it was not immediately clear whether the envelope shown in the photographs contained it. The Iranian government further said in a post on X that the two leaders reviewed bilateral relations



Pakistan’s Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi (left) with Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi

and “exchanged views on the latest status of the ongoing diplomatic process mediated by Pakistan” to end the West Asia conflict.

In a separate post, it said the two also discussed “issues of mutual interest” and ways to “further strengthen coopera-

tion” between their countries.

Islamabad, however, has so far not said anything about the message or the meeting in Tehran. Naqvi arrived in Tehran on Saturday night, where he was received by his Iranian counterpart Eskandar Momeni.

Naqvi is also expected

to meet President Masoud Pezeshkian and other senior Iranian officials during the visit, according to Iranian sources. The visit comes at a time when Pakistan has accelerated efforts to revive the US-Iran peace negotiations.

Pakistan has positioned

Highlights

- » The Pakistan minister was along with a message addressed to Iran’s Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei
- » Photographs released by the Iranian authorities showed Naqvi handing over an envelope to Araghchi
- » Islamabad, however, has so far not said anything about the message or the meeting in Tehran

itself as a facilitator between Washington and Tehran and has maintained contacts with both sides. In April, Islamabad hosted the first round of talks between the two sides, but they failed to clinch a peace deal.

Diplomatic sources said Naqvi’s visit was part of Pakistan’s efforts to preserve a ceasefire arrangement that Islamabad helped broker earlier this year and to encourage renewed engagement between Washington and Tehran. AGENCIES

Bangladesh, Turkiye form joint defence, foreign affairs panel

DHAKA: Bangladesh and Turkiye have reached an understanding to form a joint ministerial level committee on defence and foreign affairs to strengthen bilateral political cooperation. The decision was announced on Saturday after a meeting between Prime Minister Tarique Rahman and Turkish Foreign Minister Hakan Fidan, who arrived in Dhaka on a three-day visit.

“Bangladesh and Turkiye have decided to form a joint committee at the ministerial level on defence and foreign affairs to strengthen bilateral relations,” the state-run BSS news agency reported quoting the prime minister’s press wing.

The meeting decided to hold annual foreign office consultations between foreign and defence ministers of the two countries to further deepen the “strategic relations,” the press wing spokesman said.

Fidan said his visit constituted the first step towards elevating Bangladesh–Turkiye relations to the “strategic level” as he simultaneously conveyed President Recep Tayyip Erdogan’s greetings to Rahman.

The press wing said the prime minister’s discussion with Fidan also focused on the Rohingya crisis, climate change, trade and investment, joint production and cooperation, and regional and inter-



Turkiye Foreign Minister Hakan Fidan with Prime Minister of Bangladesh Tarique Rahman

“THE TURKISH FM ALSO HELD A BILATERAL MEETING WITH HIS COUNTERPART KHALILUR RAHMAN”

national matters of mutual interest. Rahman thanked Turkiye for its continued support to Dhaka, particularly for backing its candidate for the presidency of the 81st UN General Assembly session

and extended an invitation to Erdogan to visit Bangladesh at a mutually convenient time in near future.

Earlier on Friday, the Turkish foreign minister held a bilateral meeting with his counterpart Khalilur Rahman and also travelled to southeastern Cox’s Bazar to visit a makeshift Rohingya camp.

The visit by the Turkish foreign minister, who arrived here on Thursday night, is part of his official tour of several countries in East and South Asia with Bangladesh being the fourth stop. AGENCIES

Israel strikes Beirut’s southern suburbs

BEIRUT: Israel struck the southern Beirut suburbs on Sunday, just days after a ceasefire agreement in Washington went into effect.

A statement from Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu’s office said the strikes were in retaliation for the Hezbollah militant group

firing toward northern Israel earlier, and that the attacks targeted “command centres” in the sprawling urban neighbourhoods. Hezbollah did not immediately claim responsibility for firing at Israel.

The strikes come after the Lebanese and Israeli governments in Washington renewed a ceasefire agreement in ongoing talks that Beirut hopes will bring an end to the war across the country. There was no immediate word of casualties.

Israel had already struck the southern suburbs of the Lebanese capital twice since the first agreement between Lebanon and Israel went into effect on April 17. Strikes over southern Lebanon continue daily, meanwhile, and

Hezbollah fighters and Israeli troops have also clashed.

Israel announced on Monday that it would strike the southern suburbs after Hezbollah claimed attacks in northern Israel, but last-gasp talks via Washington halted the attacks, on the condition that Hezbollah stop targeting Israel’s border towns.

Iran had warned that an attack on the Lebanese capital would trigger renewed full-scale war across the Mideast, amid ongoing efforts by Pakistan to restart talks between Tehran and Washington.

The Iranian-backed Hezbollah has rejected the US-brokered deal and instead endorsed Iran’s demand that ending the war in Lebanon be part of the negotiations with the US. AGENCIES

ATLEAST ONE PERSON KILLED, FIVE INJURED

Arab attacker opens fire in central Israel

TEL AVIV: A Palestinian man with Israeli citizenship went on a shooting rampage in several towns in central Israel on Sunday, killing one person and wounding five others, according to Israeli police. The attacker was killed by the police.

The attack came at a time of heightened tensions following a spate of Israeli settler attacks and the deadly shooting of a Palestinian baby over the weekend in the nearby West Bank. Police identified the attacker as a resident of the Arab town of Taybeh in his 20s, but his precise motives were not immediately known.

The attack began with a shooting on Sunday morning



Israeli security forces being deployed at the scene of a shooting attack carried out by a Palestinian citizen of Israel in Israel on Sunday AP/PTI

at a gas station near the town of Kokhav Yair, located on the Israeli side of the boundary with the occupied West Bank.

Several other shootings were reported in two nearby Israeli towns and close to the Israeli settlement of Salit, inside the

West Bank.

Police initially feared a series of coordinated attacks but eventually determined that a gunman and an accomplice who may have served as his driver were involved. The suspected accomplice was arrested later after he tried to stab the police with a glass bottle.

Police said a 35-year-old Israeli man was killed by the gunman in Kokhav Yair, while the Magen David Adom rescue service said five other people were wounded, two severely.

Fears of a widespread attack prompted authorities to order residents to stay at home, and children in the area were kept in lockdown at school for at least three hours. AGENCIES

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Arun Kumar** S/o Jagbir Singh R/o A-62 Gali No. 1, Jain Colony, Barwala, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 1518/2014 U/s 186/353/356/379/427/34 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Arun Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Arun Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Arun Kumar** in **FIR No. 1518/2014 U/s 186/353/356/379/427/34 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.07.2026**.

By order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7600/ON/2026

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **India SME Asset Reconstruction Company Limited [CIN : U67190MH2008PLC181062]** (“Secured Creditor”), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on “as is where is”, “as is what is” and “whatever there is” basis on **25.06.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M.**, for recovery of **Rs. 27,03,54/- (Rupees Twenty Seven Lakh Three Thousand Five Hundred Forty Four only)** pending towards **Loan Account No. HHLVAS00406959**, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till **29.05.2026** with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. **30.05.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **MOHIT GUPTA and RUHI KHANDLWAL**.

The Loan Account bearing No. **HHLVAS00406959**, along with all right(s), title(s), interest(s), underlying security(ies), pledge(s) and / or guarantee(s), including the Immovable Property, has been assigned by Sammaan Capital Limited (“SCL”) (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) to and in favour of the Secured Creditor acting as a **Trustee of ISARC - 2025-2026-5 Trust** vide Assignment Agreement dated **26.12.2025**. The Secured Creditor has duly taken over the financial facility from SCL and is thus, vested with all powers and entitled to recover its outstanding dues in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) and / or enforcement of security interest in relation to the Immovable Property.

The Reserve Price for the Immovable Property will be **Rs. 20,60,000/- (Rupees Twenty Lakh Sixty Thousand only)** and the Earnest Money Deposit (“EMD”) will be **Rs. 2,06,000/- (Rupees Two Lakh Six Thousand only)**, i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

ENTIRE THIRD FLOOR WITH ROOF / TERRACE RIGHTS UPSTO SKY OF FREEHOLD BUILT - UP PROPERTY BEARING NUMBER 54, AREA MEASURING 25.90 SQUARE METERS, IN POKET - 20, SECTOR - 24, SITUATED IN THE LAYOUT PLAN OF ROHINI RESIDENTIAL SCHEME, ROHINI, NEW DELHI - 110085, ALONG WITH COMMON ENTRANCE, PASSAGE AND STAIRCASE WITH PROPORTIONATE FREE HOLD RIGHTS OF THE LAND UNDERNEATH THE ABOVE SAID PROPERTY.

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i. e. www.isarc.in; Helpline No : 0124-6910910, +91 7085451024; E - mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

sdi-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
INDIA SME ASSET RECONSTRUCTION COMPANY LIMITED
Date : 02.06.2026
Place : NEW DELHI
Trustee of ISARC - 2025-2026-5 Trust

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Shoeb** S/o Shahid R/o H. No. 11325, Subhash Park, Shahdara, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 493/2019 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, PS Shastri Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Shoeb** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shoeb** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Shoeb** in **FIR No. 493/2019 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, PS Shastri Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.07.2026**.

By order
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Judicial Magistrate First Class -03
North East District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/7619/NE/2026

MANHUNT FOR SUSPECTS

At least 12 people injured in shooting near Ohio festival

TOLEDO: A shooting near a community festival in Toledo, Ohio, wounded at least 12 people,

and police said a search for the suspects was ongoing following an outbreak of gunfire that sent crowds scrambling for cover. Two of the injured were in a critical condition, Toledo Deputy Police Chief Joe Heffernan said. He said it appeared there were at least two people firing weapons who were “probably shooting at each other.”

The Toledo Police Department said the shooting happened near the Old West End Festival, an annual gathering of live music and home tours in a historic district of the city.

The department said an active search was underway for those responsible.

“I am deeply concerned about the situation in Toledo tonight. Summer festivals should be safe spaces for families to spend time together without fear of violence,” Ohio Gov. Mike DeWine said in a statement. AGENCIES



President Donald Trump

either way,” he said. Trump asserted that no sanctions on Iran would be lifted or assets unfrozen upfront till the peace deal is reached.

“Yeah. If they behave, if they do a good job, we start talking. Yeah,” Trump said

‘No sanctions on Iran would be lifted or assets unfrozen upfront till the peace deal is reached’

when asked whether he would consider unfreezing Iranian assets later if not immediately.

Trump also said that he was not demanding that Lebanon be a part of a short-term deal with Tehran.

“They’ve conceded

the fact that they will not have nuclear weapons. We had a clause in there that (they) will not develop nuclear weapons. And everybody was very happy with it except me,” Trump said, adding that he wanted an additional provision to ensure Iran can’t execute an end run around a deal.

“And I said, ‘Well, what happens if they, not develop, but they go out and purchase, they acquire? I want to put the word, ‘if they buy, purchase or acquire,’ he said.

“You know, you’ve got to

have that in there, too, because that’s not developing. So, they don’t have the right to develop or purchase, acquire or buy,” Trump said.

Trump said he was looking to keep US troops deployed in the region until “completion.”

The US President said that he is finding Iran’s new leadership to be “more rational, very smart” and was open to speaking with Iran’s new supreme leader Mojtaba Khamenei.

“I would if he’d like to,” Trump said, “but I have not spoken to him directly.” AGENCIES

Palestinians suffer from lack of proper toilets across Gaza’s vast tent cities

Displaced families have largely been left on their own to dig their own latrines

KHAN YOUNIS: In their bare-bones tent in southern Gaza, Mostafa Shaaban built his family’s makeshift toilet behind a curtain in a corner. He dug a shallow pit in the sandy soil, poured a concrete slab around it, fixed a bottomless bucket over the hole, then topped it off with a battered, plastic toilet seat.

It reeks with a foul odour and buzzes with flies and mosquitoes only a few feet from where they sleep and prepare meals.

Every week, Shaaban has to dig the sewage sludge out of the pit. But at least it’s more private than the fetid communal latrines used by hundreds of other people in their sprawling tent camp.

“I did not want the kids and my wife to use any public toilet. It is humiliating,” said the 38-year-old Shaaban, who was driven from his home city of Rafah by Israeli forces two years ago and eventually settled in a tent camp in Khan Yunis. “The situation is revolt-



Palestinians inspect the rubble of a building destroyed in an Israeli airstrike at Khan Yunis AP/PTI

ing,” he said of having the toilet inside the tent, “but at least it has more dignity.”

There is not a single proper toilet across the vast tent cities housing most of Gaza’s 1.7 million Palestinians left homeless by the war. Displaced families have largely been left on their

own to dig their own latrines, some shared by extended families.

At communal camp toilets, men, women and children wait in long lines then do their business behind a thin cloth or sheet of metal separating them from the crowd of strangers outside.

Women fear walking to the communal toilets at night.

The result is a hygienic nightmare as horrible smells drift among the tightly packed tents and pools of sewage collect from leaking cesspits or from people dumping the contents of their latrines. AGENCIES

‘India’s growth remains robust despite costlier oil’

‘India is better placed than most energy importers to absorb higher oil prices without major damage to growth’

NEW DELHI: India’s growth momentum remains strong and fears that crude price shocks will derail it are a “narrative problem, not reality,” said Neelkanth Mishra, India’s newly appointed Executive Director at the World Bank.

Mishra argued that India is better placed than most energy importers to absorb higher oil prices without major damage to growth. Mishra is also a member of the Prime Minister’s Economic Advisory Council and is widely known for his work as an economist and market expert.

On growth, Mishra pointed out India expanded 7.1 per cent in FY25 despite monetary and fiscal headwinds, meaning credit growth was slowing & the government was tightening the fiscal deficit. “If our growth was 7.1 per cent despite fiscal and monetary tightening, it means without that, growth would have been higher,” he said.

Now, with monetary tailwinds as credit growth accelerates and the budgeted deficit not lower than last year, he estimates the economy was growing at 8 per cent+ till February-March 2026. He cited ground indicators: 29 per cent YoY car sales growth in May, strong mall footfalls and sales, and cement demand in high single dig-



‘India expanded 7.1 per cent in FY25 despite monetary and fiscal headwinds, meaning credit growth was slowing and the govt was tightening fiscal deficit’

its. “You can’t build inventory of cement...whatever is being bought is being consumed,” he noted, making it hard to justify negative sentiment.

On crude, Mishra explained why India’s vulnerability is lower than headlines suggest. Because Indian oil marketing companies are also refiners, they benefit from refining margins when diesel cracks rise. If pre-war crude was \$70/barrel with a \$20 diesel crack, landed cost was \$90. Today at \$100 crude and \$50 crack, other countries face \$150, while India faces \$120.

With diesel cracks now cooling and oil around \$94-95/barrel, “India does not need to raise any further fuel prices.” The feared implicit subsidy of Rs 20-30/litre is not needed; the Rs 8/litre cushion is sufficient as oil prices have eased due to inventory releases by China and the US. He quantified the headwind: at \$100/barrel, oil creates a 2 per cent drag on growth -- like an aircraft slowing from 900 to 700 km/h due to headwinds. But fiscal support such as fertilizer price caps won’t be needed by March 2027 as oil futures are

Highlights

- » ‘If our growth was 7.1% despite fiscal and monetary tightening, it means without that, growth would have been higher’
- » ‘Now, as the credit growth accelerates & budgeted deficit not lower than last year, the economy is estimated to grow at 8%+ till February-March 2026’
- » ‘The bigger challenge is managing narrative until data proves resilience’

at \$80/barrel. At \$80, the economy can re-accelerate. The only serious vulnerability he flagged is the currency, not growth. He stressed India is fiscally more disciplined than in past oil shocks. While energy price shocks remain a risk, the current combination of strong domestic demand, fading fiscal/monetary headwinds, and India’s refining surplus means growth can stay near 7.5-8 per cent even with elevated crude. The bigger challenge, he said, is managing the narrative until data proves the resilience.

AGENCIES

Pvt investment rises to ₹56L cr in previous fiscal: SBI Research

The report noted that overall investment announcements in the economy have risen significantly over the years

MUMBAI: Private investment announcements rose sharply to Rs 56 lakh crore in FY26 from Rs 37 lakh crore in the previous year, indicating that investment momentum in the economy is gathering pace despite concerns over weak private sector capital expenditure, according to an SBI Research report.

In its latest Ecowrap report, SBI Research said, “Private investment announcements in FY26 is Rs 56 lakh crore from Rs 37 lakh crore in previous year.”

The report noted that overall investment announcements in the economy have risen significantly over the years, reflecting increasing confidence among businesses.

“The total investment announcements shows an increasing trend through the period from Rs 17 lakh crore in FY19 to Rs 80 lakh crore in FY26,” SBI Research said.

According to the report, manufacturing remained the biggest contributor to fresh investment proposals during FY26.

“The manufacturing sector contributes around 28.9%, followed by power sector (28.7%) and building infrastructure (23.1%) in total new investment announcements of FY26,” it said.

SBI Research argued that the latest GDP data also point to strengthening investment



‘The total investment announcements shows an increasing trend from Rs 17 lakh crore in FY19 to Rs 80 lakh crore in FY26,’ SBI Research said

activity in the economy.

“It’s now an opportune time to understand the trends in private investment as the official GDP data shows investment momentum has gained momentum in FY26, with particularly a large uptick in Q4,” the report said.

The report highlighted that gross fixed capital formation, a key measure of investment in the economy, grew 10.8 per cent in the fourth quarter of FY26, reflecting strong investment activity.

Apart from new project announcements, SBI Research said the expansion of corporate assets also suggests sustained

investment by India Inc.

“Apart from new investment announcement, another important data point is addition in gross block,” the report said.

It added that the gross block of more than 5,000 listed companies increased substantially over the last four years.

“Gross block of Indian Inc., represented by around 5000+ listed entities, is estimated to have increased from Rs 87 lakh crore as of March 2022 to Rs 145 lakh crore as of March’2026,” the report said.

SBI Research further noted that companies have consistently expanded their productive assets over the past five years.

“What is pertinent to mention is on an average Indian Inc have added more than Rs 13 lakh crore of gross block yearly in last five years,” it said.

The report comes at a time when private sector capital expenditure has remained a key focus area for economists and policymakers assessing the durability of India’s growth momentum.

According to SBI Research, the rise in investment announcements and asset creation suggests that private investment activity is strengthening and becoming a more important driver of economic growth.

AGENCIES

‘Oil prices, inflation data to drive gold this week’



NEW DELHI: Gold prices will remain sensitive to developments in West Asia, movement in crude oil prices & a series of key economic data releases in the coming week, analysts said.

Investors will monitor trade and inflation data from China & the US, mid-month Washington’s consumer sentiment figures & India’s Consumer Price Index readings.

The European Central Bank’s monetary policy decision will also be in focus as market participants assess their impact on bullion and other commodities, they added.

Domestic commodity markets ended the week lower, with MCX gold futures for August delivery falling Rs 5,317, or 3.3 per cent, to Rs 1.55 lakh per 10 grams. Silver for July delivery fell Rs 18,461, or 7 per cent, to Rs 2.48 lakh per kilogram on the MCX.

In the global markets, Comex gold futures shed \$227.7, or 5 per cent, to end the week at \$4,365 per ounce, while silver fell \$6.77, or nearly 9 per cent, to \$69.10 per ounce.

PTI

‘FII trading activity and oil prices to guide markets this week’

NEW DELHI: Stock market this week will track simmering tensions in West Asia, its impact on crude oil prices, and trading activity of foreign institutional investors (FIIs), analysts said.

The trading week may begin on a cautious note following a sharp decline in the US markets over the week-end, an expert said. Besides, progress of monsoon and inflation data announcement will also be important factors to watch out for.

“This week will be driven by key inflation, and global macroeconomic data releases. In India, investors will closely track inflation data for May, scheduled for release on June 12, along with foreign exchange reserves data on the same day.

“Globally, developments around the US-Iran negotiations and their implications for crude oil prices, currency movements, and overall risk sentiment will remain in focus,” Ajit Mishra, SVP, Research, Religare Broking Ltd, said.

US markets ended sharply lower on Friday, with the Nasdaq Composite tumbling 4.18 per cent. The S&P 500 dived 2.64 per cent and Dow Jones Industrial Average declined 1.35 per cent.

Last week, the BSE benchmark Sensex declined 532.4 points, or 0.71 per cent, and the NSE Nifty dipped 181.05 points, or 0.76 per cent.

PTI

Mcap of top-7 cos erodes by ₹1.25 lakh crore

NEW DELHI: The combined market valuation of seven of the top-10 most-valued firms eroded by Rs 1.25 lakh crore last week, with Reliance Industries taking the biggest hit, in-line with a bearish trend in equities.

Last week, the BSE benchmark Sensex declined 532.4 points, or 0.71 per cent, and the NSE Nifty dipped 181.05 points, or 0.76 per cent.

From the top-10 pack, Reliance Industries, Bharti Airtel, TCS, Bajaj Finance, Larsen & Toubro, Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) and Hindustan Unilever faced erosion from their valuation, while HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, and SBI were the gainers.

The market valuation of Reliance Industries dropped Rs 39,718 crore to Rs 17,47,321.40 crore.

TCS faced an erosion of Rs 20,134.66 crore from its valuation, which stood at Rs 7,95,346.09 crore.

Market Cap				
Top 10 (BSE)		₹ crore	As on June 5, 2026	Gain/Loss over May 29, 2026
RIL			17,47,321.40	▼ -39,718.00
HDFC Bank			11,50,743.31	▲ 4,101.47
Bharti Airtel			10,96,150.49	▼ -18,736.04
ICICI Bank			9,05,074.77	▲ 4,484.86
SBI			9,02,523.63	▲ 12,692.09
TCS			7,95,346.09	▼ -20,134.66
Bajaj Finance			5,53,580.97	▼ -9,681.36
Larsen & Toubro			5,43,956.44	▼ -16,880.20
LIC			5,05,873.32	▼ -14,610.74
Hind Unilever			4,98,301.31	▼ -5,909.23

Bharti Airtel’s market valuation dived Rs 18,736.04 crore to Rs 10,96,150.49 crore and that of Larsen & Toubro tumbled Rs 16,880.20 crore to Rs 5,43,956.44 crore.

KBK Infographics

Reliance Infra Ltd faces curb on trading in shares, seeks review of insolvency-linked surveillance framework

NEW DELHI: Reliance Infrastructure Ltd on Sunday said that it has sought a review of the insolvency-related surveillance framework, under which trading in the company’s stock is allowed only once a week.

Reliance Infrastructure Limited, in a statement, said it has submitted a formal representation to the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), National Stock Exchange (NSE), and Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE), seeking a review of the Additional Surveillance Measure (ASM) linked to Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) and the related trading restrictions on its shares.

Citing adverse impact on more than 7 lakh public shareholders, Reliance Infra said that the current framework, which permits trading only once a week within a narrow ±5 per cent price band, results in price movements that are largely mechanical and predictable.

It emphasised the need to ensure that market mechanisms continue to facilitate fair price discovery and maintain investor confidence.

“The company believes that such restrictions may not adequately reflect prevailing business fundamentals, operational performance or long-term value creation potential,” it said.

According to the statement, Reliance Infrastructure shares are otherwise actively and widely traded in the market, reflecting sustained investor participation and liquidity.

The company said the continuation of such anomalous and artificial trading restrictions is counterproductive to the interests of 7 lakh retail and small public shareholders and undermines the efficient functioning of the market.

The company further submitted that the impact of these restrictions falls disproportionately on its public shareholders.

“During lower-circuit phases, shareholders are often

unable to exit their investments at a reasonable market price, while the value of their holdings erodes by a near-fixed percentage each week,” the statement said.

In its representation, Reliance Infrastructure has proposed a calibrated approach that retains key risk-mitigation measures, including gross settlement, 100 per cent margin requirements, Additional Surveillance Deposit (ASD) and price-band safeguards, while enabling more effective price discovery.

“The Company has requested regulators to consider alternatives such as a peri-

odic call-auction mechanism or a wider and graded price band to facilitate genuine two-sided trading,” it said.

According to the company, the ASM framework was triggered despite the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) staying both the insolvency admission order and the Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) against Reliance Infrastructure.

No resolution professional has assumed control of the company and that its affairs continue to be managed by its duly constituted board of directors in the normal course of business, it said.

MPOST

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



In a significant step towards promoting renewable energy and sustainable development, the Governor of Odisha, Hari Babu Kambhampati, inaugurated a 485 kWp Rooftop Solar Photovoltaic (PV) Power Plant at Lok Bhavan, Bhubaneswar, developed and executed by NBCC (India) Limited. The inauguration was held in the presence of Dr. K. P Mahadevaswamy, CMD, NBCC and J P Guru, SBG, Odisha, NBCC.

MPOST

‘Tata Motors to expand hydrogen, EV push in CVs’

NEW DELHI: Tata Motors will continue investing in electric and hydrogen-based technologies for commercial vehicles (CVs). Chairman N Chandrasekaran said, stressing that cleaner mobility will require a mix of electric, hydrogen & cleaner internal combustion engine solutions.

In his message to shareholders in the company’s FY26 annual report, Chandrasekaran said advances in digital technologies and artificial intelligence are transforming mobility products and services. He added that the shift to clean energy, rising safety expectations and changing global supply chains are reshaping

competitiveness, while geopolitical uncertainties and uneven economic recovery are increasing business challenges.

The company will continue expanding its zero-emission electric CV portfolio while investing in hydrogen technologies for heavier-duty segments, he said.

Chandrasekaran expressed confidence in Tata Motors’ growth prospects, supported by a strong balance sheet and improving returns. The company reported record revenue of Rs 83,855 crore in 2025-26, up 9.8 per cent from FY25, while automotive return on capital employed stood at 72.3 per cent.

AGENCIES

RIO DE JANEIRO: The International Air Transport Association (IATA) has said the ongoing energy shock triggered by the West Asia crisis should accelerate the development of renewable fuels, including sustainable aviation fuel (SAF), even as global production remains far below what is needed for the aviation sector’s decarbonisation goals.

Jet fuel prices have surged in recent weeks, increasing operating costs for airlines worldwide. Against this backdrop, IATA urged governments to expand renewable energy supplies, strengthen policy sup-

port, and ensure open access to fuel infrastructure to boost SAF production.

IATA Director General Willie Walsh said the current energy crisis underscores the need for greater energy independence and faster adoption of cleaner fuels. However, he noted that governments have yet to create the incentives required for a viable SAF market.

SAF production is projected to reach around 2.4 million tonnes (MT) in 2026, accounting for just 0.8 per cent of global aviation fuel consumption, while costing airlines an estimated \$4.3 billion. Despite this,

CLOSER LOOK

- » IATA urged governments to expand renewable energy supplies, strengthen policy support, and ensure open access to fuel infrastructure to boost SAF production
- » The current energy crisis underscores need for greater energy independence & faster adoption of cleaner fuels
- » SAF output is estimated to reach around 2.4 MT in 2026, accounting for 0.8% of global aviation fuel consumption

global SAF production capacity is expected to be nearly 9 million tonnes, indicating significant underutilisation.

Speaking on the sidelines of the IATA Annual General Meeting in Rio de Janeiro, Preeti Jain,

Head of Net Zero Research and Programs at IATA, said existing policy frameworks favour renewable diesel production over SAF, limiting output despite available capacity.

Walsh described the outlook

as disappointing, noting that five years after airlines committed to achieving net-zero emissions by 2050, SAF still represents less than 1 per cent of fuel use. He blamed poorly sequenced government policies and insufficient interest from oil companies for slowing progress.

To scale up production, IATA has called for production incentives and investment frameworks that reduce risks and provide certainty before governments impose blending mandates. It also stressed the need for a global SAF market capable of delivering adequate volumes at commercially via-

ble prices.

The industry body also highlighted challenges surrounding electro-SAF (e-SAF), a synthetic fuel produced using renewable electricity, green hydrogen, water and captured carbon dioxide.

While the EU and the UK have mandated around 0.6 million tonnes of e-SAF production by 2030, global capacity currently operating or under construction is only about 0.02 million tonnes.

IATA estimates that around 20 commercial-scale refineries would be needed to meet the mandated volumes.

AGENCIES

OPEC+ clears oil 4th output hike since Hormuz closure

The war has cut oil flows via the Strait of Hormuz, creating the world’s biggest-ever supply crisis

LONDON: OPEC+ agreed on Sunday a fourth increase in its oil output targets in as many months, even though the U.S. war with Iran is still preventing several of the group’s members from pumping more.

The war has cut oil flows via the Strait of Hormuz, creating the world’s biggest-ever supply crisis as key OPEC+ members including Saudi Arabia have been unable to supply customers in full since the end of February.

The crisis for OPEC+ deepened when the UAE left the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries after almost 60 years, Reuters reported. Seven core members of OPEC+, which groups OPEC and allied producers including Russia, have increased their output quotas from April to June by almost 600,000 barrels per day. In reality, the group’s production has collapsed due to export cuts by Gulf members, averaging 33.19 million bpd in April compared with 42.77 million in February, according to OPEC figures.

On Sunday, the seven members decided to increase targets by 188,000 bpd from July, OPEC said in a statement. This is the same as the June hike, which was adjusted down from monthly increases of 206,000



On Sunday, the seven members decided to increase targets by 188,000 bpd from July, OPEC said in a statement

bpd in May and April to take into account the UAE exit.

“An OPEC+ production increase means very little while the Strait of Hormuz remains closed,” said Jorge Leon, an analyst at Rystad and a former OPEC official. “When the Strait of Hormuz reopens, the market could move very quickly from fear of shortage to fear of surplus.”

On Friday, oil prices fell to around \$93 a barrel as traders gained confidence that renewed conflict between the U.S. and Iran was growing less likely. Prices were close to \$72 before

the war began.

The seven countries are increasing production as part of the gradual unwinding of a 1.65 million bpd production cut that the group, which at the time included UAE, agreed in 2023.

From July, the seven have about 567,000 bpd of the original cut to return to the market, taking into account the UAE exit from May 1, according to Reuters calculations.

That would mean the rest of the cut will be unwound by the end of September should OPEC+ stick to monthly hikes of about 188,000 bpd for August

Highlights

- » This is the same as the June hike, which was adjusted down from monthly increases of 206,000 bpd in May and April
- » ‘An OPEC+ production increase means very little while the Strait of Hormuz remains closed’
- » ‘When the Strait of Hormuz reopens, the market could move very quickly from fear of shortage to fear of surplus’

and September. The seven of 21 OPEC+ members who met on Sunday are Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Kuwait, Algeria, Kazakhstan, Russia, and Oman. In recent years, only the seven plus the UAE when it was a member have been involved in the group’s output policy decisions.

Three other OPEC and OPEC+ meetings, including one of all OPEC+ ministers, were also scheduled for Sunday. The meeting of all OPEC+ ministers is not expected to make any changes to group-wide output policy, OPEC+ sources said earlier on Sunday. AGENCIES

AS TRANSMISSION & THERMAL CAPEX RAMP UP

Adani Power, Adani Energy Solutions, set for over 20% growth, says Jefferies

NEW DELHI: Adani Group’s power plays are entering a multi-year growth phase as India’s transmission and base-load power demand tailwinds. Jefferies’ management meet notes for Adani Energy Solutions Ltd and Adani Power Ltd, dated June 5, 2026, highlight robust bid pipelines, locked-in PPAs, and improving financial metrics that support double-digit medium-term growth.

Adani Energy Solutions Ltd India’s only listed private pure-play on transmission and distribution, is executing transmission projects worth Rs 718 billion, up 20 per cent YoY, against a near-term bid pipeline of Rs 1.5 trillion vs Rs 540 billion at end-FY25. Jefferies expects AESL to deliver 27 per cent EBITDA CAGR and 19 per cent PAT CAGR over FY26-30E, growing 2x+ faster than Power Grid’s 13 per cent EBITDA and 8 per cent PAT CAGR for the same period. AESL’s premium to PGCIL has compressed to 133 per cent from 991 per cent in Jan 2023, making valuations relatively attractive as execution sustains.

Smart meters are the other key driver. AESL installed 11.4 million meters by end-FY26 vs 3.1 million YoY, beating its 7 million target. With 100 million meters still to be bid out of the government’s 250 million target, AESL is executing projects worth Rs 295 billion or 24.6 million meters. Jefferies models a ramp to 11 million



Adani Energy Solutions is executing transmission projects of Rs 718 bn, up 20% against a near-term bid pipeline of Rs 1.5 trillion vs Rs 540 bn at end-FY25

meters by FY27-29E, requiring wins of another 19 million in the next 12-18 months from tenders in Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, MP, Gujarat and Andhra Pradesh. Early-stage C&I and cooling solutions, especially for data centres, add long-term optionality.

Balance sheet strength supports growth. Net debt-to-equity was 1.8x as of March 2026 after a \$1 billion QIP in Aug 2024. AESL can expand transmission gross block 2.6x by FY30E and smart meter block to Rs 305 billion from Rs 64 billion without breaching 3x leverage. ROE should move toward 13 per cent by FY30E as inter-

est costs fall and commissioned assets add EBITDA.

Adani Power reiterated its target to expand capacity 2.3x to 42 GW by FY32. Thermal remains critical for India’s baseload, and 56 per cent of the upcoming 23.7 GW is already under long-term PPAs, with the aim to tie up 100 per cent. PPA tariffs are improving — recent 8 GW signed Aug 2025-Mar 2026 with Bihar, MP, Assam, Uttarakhand and Tamil Nadu SEBs at Rs 5.8-6.3/unit vs Rs 5.4/unit for Raipur in Sept 2024.

Jefferies models 23 per cent EBITDA CAGR for APL over FY26-30E and expects it to turn free cash flow positive by FY30E

Key Points

- » Jefferies expects AESL to deliver 27% EBITDA CAGR and 19% PAT CAGR over FY26-30E
- » This growth will be 2x+ faster than Power Grid’s 13% EBITDA & 8% PAT CAGR for same period
- » Jefferies expects APL to deliver 23% EBITDA CAGR over FY26-30E, expects it to turn free cash flow +ve by FY30E
- » Net debt/EBITDA will peak at 3.4x in FY27E before falling to 2x by FY30E, among the lowest in the sector

as capacity hits 31 GW. Operating cash flow should grow 20 per cent CAGR, keeping leverage at 0.7x despite capex. Net debt/EBITDA will peak at 3.4x in FY27E before falling to 2x by FY30E, among the lowest in the sector. Capacity rose 33 per cent to 18.3 GW by May 2026, with land and equipment for 42 GW already secured from L&T and BHEL. 6.9 GW should be operational by FY29E, underpinning 20 per cent+ EBITDA growth visibility. Together, AESL’s transmission and smart meter execution and APL’s PPA-backed thermal expansion give Adani’s power vertical clear earnings visibility through FY30. AGENCIES

Indian cos got less aid than Chinese peers in 2005-24: OECD

NEW DELHI: Indian firms received significantly lower government support than their Chinese counterparts during 2005-2024, according to an OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development) report.

OECD MAGIC Database of Industrial Subsidies measures what firms actually receive (not what governments disclose),

covering 525 of the world’s largest manufacturers across 15 key sectors over 2005-24, through three instruments: grants, income-tax concessions, and below-market borrowings (cheap state-bank loans).

“Between 2005 and 2024, Chinese firms received on average three to eight times more government support than firms based in the OECD, a conser-

vative estimate. These subsidies were also considerably higher than the support received by firms based in non-OECD economies such as Brazil, India, and Indonesia,” the report said.

This reflects one of the key factors behind China’s manufacturing competitiveness. The OECD is an inter-governmental body comprising 38 mostly advanced economies that works

to promote economic growth, trade, investment, and policy coordination among member countries. It members include the US, the UK, Canada, Germany, France, Italy, Japan, South Korea, and Australia.

The report also said around 22 per cent of the global market share gains of firms that grew between 2005 and 2023 can be explained by the subsidies they

received.

For Chinese firms, almost 60 per cent of their global market share gains can be explained by the subsidies received, it added.

Further, World Trade Organization members making no subsidy notification rose from 26 (1995) to 117 (2025) -- from 23 per cent to 70 per cent -- eroding trust in global markets, it said. PTI

India eyes better mkt access via easier SPS rules under trade pact with EAEU

NEW DELHI: India is eyeing easier compliance with SPS (sanitary and phytosanitary measures) and TBT (technical barriers to trade) requirements under the proposed free trade agreement with the Russia-led EAEU group, an official said.

Complex testing, certification and regulatory procedures

under these often act as non-tariff barriers, which increase costs for exporters and delay shipments.

Simplifying these norms would help boost exports of products such as marine goods, agricultural items and processed foods to the EAEU market. India and the five-nation

grouping, the Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU), inked the terms of reference to negotiate a free trade agreement on August 20 last year. The first round of negotiations was held in November 2025 here.

The second round is expected later this month in Moscow, the official said. PTI

Sport

BEATS FLAVIO COBOLLI IN 5 SETS

Zverev wins 1st Grand Slam title

Zverev has now joined an elite group of players that captured their first major in their fourth final: Eight-time major champion Andre

PARIS: Alexander Zverev is no longer one of the best players never to win a major title. He’s finally a Grand Slam champion.

In his fourth major final, Zverev beat Flavio Cobolli 6-1, 4-6, 6-4, 6-7 (5), 6-1 for the French Open title on Sunday.

It was a unique opportunity for Zverev without Jannik Sinner or Carlos Alcaraz across the net and the third-ranked German took full advantage on the red clay of Roland Garros.

When Cobolli missed an overhead on the second championship point after more than four hours of the five-set encounter, Zverev dropped on his back to the clay and covered his face with his hands as he began sobbing.

When he got up, with his shirt and arms covered in clay, Zverev put his hands back on his face before he lifted both arms in celebration.

Zverev has now joined an elite group of players that captured their first major in their fourth final: Eight-time major champion Andre



Germany’s Alexander Zverev reacts t the French Open match on Sunday

AP/PTI

Agassi, 2001 Wimbledon winner Goran Ivanisevic and 2020 U.S. Open champion Dominic Thiem.

Zverev had been an overwhelming favorite for the title ever since the top-ranked Sinner struggled in the first week’s heat wave and wasted a two set

and 5-1 lead against Juan Manuel Cerundolo in the second round. A day later, 24-time Grand Slam champion Novak Djokovic was also eliminated.

Alcaraz, the two-time reigning champion, withdrew before the tournament with an injured right wrist. It was

Zverev’s second French Open final, having wasted a lead of two sets to one against Alcaraz in the 2024 championship match.

Zverev had an even bigger advantage — two sets to none — in the 2020 U.S. Open final and lost that one, too, to Thiem.

Highlights

- » Zverev had an even bigger advantage — two sets to none — in the 2020 U.S. Open final and lost that one, too, to Thiem
- » A day later, 24-time Grand Slam champion Novak Djokovic was also eliminated
- » Zverev put his hands back on his face before he lifted both arms in celebration

He was also beaten in straight sets by Sinner in the 2025 Australian Open final.

It was the 25th title of Zverev’s career.

The 14th-ranked Cobolli had never been past a Grand Slam quarterfinal until this week. He was attempting to become the first Italian man to raise the singles trophy at Roland Garros since Adriano Panatta 50 years ago. AGENCIES

Suthar brilliant on debut as India take control against Afghanistan

MULLANPUR: Debutant Manav Suthar’s classical left-arm spin bowling was a beacon of hope for a bright future as his three wickets gave India complete control on the second day of their one-off Test against Afghanistan here on Sunday.

With mercury soaring, India declared their first innings at 564 for 8 once Washington Sundar scored a pressure-free half-century while adding 54 useful runs with Suthar (28 off 41 balls).

At stumps, Afghanistan were tottering at 113 for 5 with Suthar recording figures of 3 for 21 in 15.5 overs.

Prasidh Krishna (2/27 in 7 overs) was the other wicket-taker. Hosts, now, are ahead by 451 runs. Having warmed up nicely with a short yet sweet maiden Test knock, Suthar got into the act straightway after being summoned to bowl the last over before tea.

He removed opener Abdul Malik, who wanted to sweep his way out of trouble after looking clueless facing first three deliveries.

A classical action and the old school diagonal run-up of bowling to right-handers while cutting between the umpire and stumps, the 23-year-old from Rajasthan’s Sri Ganga-



India’s Manav Suthar bowls on day two of a Test match between India and Afghanistan, in Mullanpur on Sunday

PTI

“AT STUMPS, AFGHANISTAN WERE TOTTERING AT 113 FOR 5 WITH SUTHAR RECORDING FIGURES OF 3 FOR 21 IN 15.5 OVERS”

nagar was a delight to watch.

In times when spin bowling is increasingly starting to become more of a restrictive weapon, thanks to the mushrooming T20 leagues, Suthar brought a lot of freshness while sticking to basics -- flight and turn. Suthar has a high release point and his main attributes included putting multiple revs

(revolutions) on the ball. He could hang the ball for an extra second in the air and also get some drift before it turns away from the right-hand batters.

The 23-year-old has a repetitive action and the pitch map on TV showed that he could land the ball on the same spot and make it do three different things. A few would turn more, a few would go straight with extra bounce forcing batters to go on back-foot, and a few others were classic arm balls that come in with the angle.

The wicket of the Afghanistan opener was one which he bowled straight and the ball bounced a tad extra making Malik’s sweep look like an ugly hoick. AGENCIES

Animesh wins silver in 200m in Taipei City

TAIPEI CITY: National record holder Animesh Kujur finished second in the men’s 200m with the fourth fastest time of career at the New Taipei City Athletics Open 2026 here on Sunday.

The 23-year-old Indian, whose national record stands at 20.32 seconds, clocked a solid 20.47seconds.

Animesh has also run 20.40 seconds and 20.45 seconds last year, and thus

The 23-year-old Indian clocked a solid 20.47seconds

his effort on Sunday was his fourth fastest time.

Thailand’s Puripol Boonsan ran a lifetime best of 20.03 seconds to finish on top and become the joint third-fastest Asian man of all time over the 200m. AGENCIES

‘Don’t expect the world from Sooryavanshi straightaway’

The 15-year-old Sooryavanshi became the youngest ever to be featured in the Indian cricket team

MUMBAI: Standing on the cusp of his India debut, young batting sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi should be allowed to settle down, and he should not be burdened with expectations, cautioned former Indian skipper Sourav Ganguly here on Sunday.

The 15-year-old Sooryavanshi became the youngest ever to be featured in the Indian cricket team when he was picked in the T20 squads for away assignments in Ireland

and England, followed by the Asian Games in Japan.

“I think we should let him be, he’s just 15-year-old and I don’t think he’ll bother too much about pressure and that’s what we get to see him in the IPL,” Ganguly told PTI in an exclusive interaction here during the launch of Kabuni.

The former BCCI president said conditions in the UK will be a lot different from what Sooryavanshi encountered in the IPL, and he will be chal-



VAIBHAV SOORYAVANSHI

lenged to adapt his game.

“Obviously, playing for India is different and he will be touring where the wickets will be a little different,” Gan-

guly said.

“It will seam and there will be a bit more bounce and a bit more movement with the new ball, so the game is a bit differ-

The former BCCI president said conditions in the UK will be a lot different from what Sooryavanshi encountered in IPL

ent, but I think he’s got enormous talent,” he added.

“... so just let him be, don’t expect the world from him

straightaway. Just allow him to settle down because you know he’s got a lot of talent like many others in India,” Ganguly said.

Meanwhile, former South Africa batter AB de Villiers did not read much into Sooryavanshi’s lack of experience and said he has “broken down the door” for national team selection. “It is easy to say that he is still too young or he is not ready or (needs to) go for more experience,” de Villiers said. AGENCIES



'I WORK FROM MY HEART, NOT FROM MY HEAD'

Karisma has reached a stage in her career where she works only when a project genuinely excites her

MUMBAI: Karisma Kapoor has reached a stage in her career where she works only when a project genuinely excites her, revealing that this approach nearly made her turn down 'Brown', in which she plays one of the most compelling roles of her career.

The series, which debuted on a streaming service recently, features the actress as a cop battling addiction and her own demons. "I work from my heart, not from my head. I'm very content with the way I am. When I want to work, I work. When I don't want to, I don't. I don't really crave or miss it so much," the 51-year-old told PTL in an interview.

'Brown' marks her series project after 2020's 'Mentalhood'. When the show came to her, Karisma said she was hesitant as she wasn't keen on committing to a project that demanded a long schedule. "I was like, 'Maybe I don't want to go and spend 50-60 days in another city'. It's a long form, a series with six, seven or eight episodes. But after



Kapoor plays Rita Brown, a disgraced, alcoholic officer haunted by her past in 'Brown'

I met Abhinay, we went through the script. I heard Rita Brown's character, of course, I couldn't say no," she said.

Set in Kolkata, 'Brown' is directed by Abhinay Deo of 'Delhi Belly' fame and produced by 'Zee Studios'. In the series, Karisma plays Rita Brown, once the city's finest cop, now a disgraced, alcoholic officer haunted by her past. She is pulled back to investigate a series of brutal murders. PTL

Celebrating indigenous culture through Shakespeare's plays in Santali language

OUR CORRESPONDENT

In a unique celebration of indigenous language and culture through world literature, the capital witnessed a two-day cultural festival presenting Shakespeare's dramas in India's Santali language by students of KIIT University and KISS, Bhubaneswar, on June 5 and 6 at the Constitution Club, New Delhi.

The inauguration on June 5 was attended by dignitaries, including Sena Latif, Ambassador of Romania; Alem Tsehaye Woldemariam, Ambassador of Eritrea; Prof. (Dr) Achyuta Samanta, Founder of KIIT and KISS and Debraj Pradhan, former Indian ambassador. The audience witnessed vibrant tribal dances, cultural presen-

tations and powerful performances from Shakespeare's 'Hamlet', 'Macbeth' and 'Romeo and Juliet', creatively adapted by indigenous students of KIIT and KISS.

Addressing the gathering, Prof. Achyuta Samanta said, "Indigenous communities possess invaluable cultural wisdom and preserving their languages is essential for humanity's collective heritage." He noted that Kaling Institute of Social Sciences (KISS), home to thousands of tribal students from diverse communities, remains committed to promoting indigenous languages, traditions and identity while providing quality education and global exposure.

The event marked the celebration of 100 years of development of the 'Ol Chiki' script



of the Santali language, bringing the tribal language to the global stage through Shakespearean theatre. The student performers had just returned from Romania after staging 'Romeo and Juliet', 'Hamlet' and 'Macbeth' in the Santali language at the International Shakespeare Festival at Craiova 2026, which featured 71 universities and 3,000 participants from 30 countries worldwide. 10 students each from KIIT

University and KISS of Bhubaneswar, Odisha, spent two months in Romania preparing for these performances. They were in Romania on a two-month-long academic and cultural internship from April 1 to May 31, under the Erasmus+ KA171 Student Mobility Programme.

"It is not a theatre event alone, but also a tribute to indigenous languages and cultures," said Dr Suryasnata



Mohanty, Joint Director, KIIT & KISS, speaking to the 'Millennium Post'. "For the first time, Shakespeare's plays have been written and enacted in Santali, the language of an Indian tribe that has a glorious history of resistance against British colonialism."

The initiative by KIIT & KISS serves as a salute to the preservation and promotion of indigenous languages and cultural traditions, aligning with global efforts to safeguard linguistic diversity. Through theatre, music, dance and storytelling, students demonstrated how indigenous

knowledge systems and languages continue to thrive while engaging with world literature.

The second day (June 6) featured the presence of Ram Nath Thakur, Union Minister of State for Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare; Abhay Kushwaha; Rampriy Mandal; Rahul Banerjee; Dr Pankaj Mittal, Secretary General of Association of Indian Universities and other eminent guests.

The two-day festival stood as a powerful symbol of cultural inclusivity, demonstrating how Shakespeare's timeless works can be reimagined through indigenous voices.



People are less forgiving now, says Saif Ali Khan

Saif Ali Khan, who was recently seen in the cop drama 'Kartavya', talked candidly about the early years of his career, the slumps, the lucky breaks and more. He also shared why he believes the film industry today is far less forgiving than before.

The actor has never shied away from acknowledging that his early work was far from impressive and he doubles down on that honesty now. In an interview with the 'Hindustan Times', Saif shared how he managed to stay afloat. "I survived because there was a massive patch where nobody wanted to do those movies that I was doing. It wasn't that I was getting the best films in the world repeatedly despite not being good. There was a strong downward movement, but then there was luck."

Khan also credited the audience of that era for being more accommodating, adding, "It was a simpler time; people were much more forgiving."

During the conversation, he was asked whether today's star kids, including his own children Sara Ali Khan and Ibrahim Ali Khan, are written off far too quickly. The actor acknowledged the generational shift: "It was definitely a more forgiving time when I came. Today, you need to be much more prepared than we were. But the whole concept of preparation has changed and some actors have always done that."

AGENCIES

They said being 30 was old for rom-coms: Taapsee

She talked about ageism and the double standards in the film industry women face as they grow older



Be it pay disparity or the inherent misogyny that continues to permeate the Hindi film industry, Taapsee Pannu has never shied away from addressing uncomfortable truths, even if it means challenging the status quo. She once again talked about

another persistent issue in the entertainment business, ageism and the double standards women face as they grow older.

In a conversation with 'Times Entertainment', Taapsee reflected on how difficult it is for actresses to establish themselves before they are deemed 'too old' for certain roles.

"I came into the Hindi film industry when I was in my mid-20s, okay? Now, for three or four years, you're struggling to get a decent role. By the time you make a mark, you've crossed 30. Then they say you're not young enough to be featured in a rom-com," she said.

Highlighting the industry's preference for younger actresses, she added, "So even till date, there are so many times when I feel like, 'But you don't really need a younger person for this role'. Yet they still want to go younger. It doesn't really happen the same way with men. Of course, we can all see that. But yes, ageism is a big thing."

According to Taapsee, similar attitudes exist in the South Indian film industry as well. Recalling her own experiences, she said, "Even in the South, it used to happen with me. The moment I was cast opposite a relatively senior actor, the younger actors didn't want to work with me. They were like, 'Oh no, she's been opposite that actor, so now...' You dare say that about Shah Rukh Khan. You know, an actress's life changes after working with Shah Rukh Khan."

'HARDEST FILM YET'

Matt talks about 'The Odyssey'

He is all set to essay Odysseus, the Greek king of Ithaca



LOS ANGELES: Matt Damon is all set to essay Odysseus, the Greek king of Ithaca, in Christopher Nolan's 'The Odyssey' and describes it as the 'hardest film' he has ever made.

The actor said that the filmmaker avoids using green screen and prefers to keep 'everything real'.

"It was by far the hardest movie I've ever made. Chris likes to shoot everything real. So, there's no kind of green screen, no faking it, no kind of studio stuff," Damon said in an 'Instagram' clip shared by animal advocacy site 'The Dodo' recently.

The film, which is set to release on July 17, also features Tom Holland, Zendaya, Robert Pattinson, Lupita Nyong'o, Anne Hathaway and Charlize Theron. It fol-

He said that Christopher Nolan avoids using green screen and prefers to keep 'everything real'

lows the Greek King Odysseus (Damon) on a perilous 10-year journey home after the Trojan War. Beset by vengeful gods, sea monsters and enchantresses, he fights to reunite with his wife, Penelope (Hathaway) and son, Telemachus (Holland).

It is produced under 'Syncopy Inc' and distributed by 'Universal Pictures'. PTL

'Melissa Joan Hart was supposed to feature in Scary Movie'

LOS ANGELES: Actor and comedian Marlon Wayans said that not Anna Faris, but Melissa Joan Hart was considered to essay the role of Cindy in the horror feature film series 'Scary Movie'.

During the promotions of the latest instalment of the film series, 'Scary Movie 6', Faris asked Wayans and Shawn Wayans if there was 'ever a celebrity that desperately wanted to be in a 'Scary Movie', but you had to hit them with a hard no?'

Wayans recalled that his elder brother and the director of the first 'Scary Movie' film, which was released in 2000, was impressed by Faris' auditions and pushed for her to get the role in the film franchise.

"Keenan was like, 'I saw this young lady Anna Faris and it really feels like that's our Cindy,'" Wayans said in an interview with 'Entertainment Tonight'.

He added, "So, you took



Melissa Joan Hart's job! Good job, Anna. Way to go. Taking food out of another white lady's mouth... White on white crime," he added.

After the release of 'Scary Movie', the franchise had another instalments, which was released in 2001, 2003, 2006 and 2013. The latest film was released on Friday and has already earned over 51 million US dollars at the global box office.

The film series also features Wayans, Regina Hall, Shawn Wayans and others. PTL





सत्यमेव जयते

दिल्ली सरकार

12 साल विश्वास के, विकास के, जनकल्याण के



आदरणीय प्रधानमंत्री
श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी जी को

समस्त दिल्लीवासियों की ओर से

हार्दिक बधाई एवं शुभकामनाएं



रेखा गुप्ता

मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली